

THE THINGS WE DO FOR LUST

Book 1: To The Edge

Sean Geist



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By

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All characters in this story are over the age of 18 unless specified.

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Chapter 1

"Thirty-one" the croupier called. "Pay odd and black."

Thirty-one, goddamn thirty-one. Why did it have to be my lucky number 31? It hit and we won \$1800.

For me 31 has always been a special number. I was born on March 31st. My wife Robin was born on July 31st. I wore the number when I played basketball in high school, and I quit the soccer team my senior year when they wouldn't let me wear it. I love the number 31. I have two vanity license plates which incorporate the number - MY31A and MY31B - and it's in most of my computer passwords (I'm not giving those numbers away).

I proposed to my wife on her 31st birthday. It was lucky for me then; she said yes, obviously, and now three years later, just three days shy of our wedding anniversary, the number came up and it paid off nicely.

I jumped out of my seat at the end of the roulette table and grabbed my wife into a full vigorous hug. I could see the excitement in her eyes.

"We won honey!" she said, pulling me into a full body hug. "Can you believe it, we won?!" She gave me a kiss on the lips. She then turned to Scott, who was sitting on the other side of her. "We won," she repeated. And then, shockingly, she gave him a kiss too. It was also a quick one, and on the cheek, but still.

My lucky god damn number. Won me eighteen hundred bucks and nearly cost me everything. But I'm getting ahead of myself. Let's back up a bit. Maybe a couple hours or so, before we won and before Scott came into our lives.

We were riding the escalator down to the main gaming floor at the Planet Hollywood Hotel and Casino. I took out our money roll and counted out five 20 dollar bills. I put the rest back in my pocket. We had a \$500

budget for gambling and it had to last until Friday. My business was picking up the tab for our hotel and meals; anything extra was up to me.

While I was worrying about our money, my wife was taking in her surroundings. This was her first trip to Vegas. She grew up in Jersey and had visited Atlantic City many times, but the boardwalk and salt water taffy couldn't compare to the hucksters and con men, hookers and panhandlers that crowded the four mile busy narrow sidewalks that ran up one side of Las Vegas Boulevard and down the other. Broadway and Times Square may come close, but nothing beats the sheer variety of humanity on display any weekday on the Strip.

Robin was caught up in the haze of cigarette smoke and clanging of digital slot machines as we neared the bottom of the escalator.

"I wanna play slots," she said. "I like those Wheel of Fortune machines."

"How about craps?" I answered. "We can win lots of money real fast."

"And lose it just as fast. A couple bad rolls and we'll be going to bed early."

"Nothing wrong with that," I said, giving her a quick slap on the ass.

She turned to me and smiled. "There'll be plenty of time for that this week, I promise you," she said. "Just wait til you see what I have planned for you on Thursday." Robin had a wicked gleam in her hazel eyes. Her matching smile sent a thrilling shiver down my spine, causing my cock to stir.

"You know your teasing gets me hard," I said.

"Yes. Yes, I do know that."

Trying to regain my composure, I looked around the casino floor. I pointed out a roulette wheel with a couple of open seats.

"Okay, how about roulette?" I said. "You get your wheel of fortune and maybe we can win lots of money."

I took the spot at the end; Robin sat next to me, around the corner. I tossed the croupier my five twenties and my players club card. "Give me singles, please," I said.

The table had a five dollar bet minimum, but I could split that up into one dollar increments while playing the numbers. Any outside bet, like Black/Red or Even/Odd, had to be at least \$5. I wasn't going to make any of those bets.

"One hundred going out," the croupier called, as she slid a rack of chips my way. They were plain yellow with a purple **PH** stamped in the middle on each side. They were only good at the roulette table, so they didn't need any of the security features of the regular chips. You take these chips away from the wheel and they lose their value.

"Good luck, sir," she said to me before adding, "Place your bets" to the other two people at the table.

I gave 20 chips to Robin. "You bet first," I said. She put two chips down on 31, of course, one of the line between 25 and 26 and she threw two chips to the dealer. "Put those on 3 and double zero," she said, instructing her to put the bets on the appropriate spots on the far side of the table.

The dealer did as asked, then gave the wheel another spin and, with a flick of her wrist, sent the little white ball on its way. While we sat back and watched the wheel and ball travel in opposite directions, the two other players at the table placed their wagers. A young black woman, spilling out of her tight green strapless dress put two \$25 chips on red. An older white man sitting next to her in a Jimmy Buffet T-shirt and black jeans scattered about 30 single chips between 10 different numbers.

The white ball had left the groove that ran along the inside of the wheel housing and was slowing down. After a few moments the dealer waved her hand across the betting table. "No more bets," she said.

The Buffet fan put down three more chips on the number eight. The dealer simply picked them up and placed them back in front of the player.

"Sorry sir, no more bets."

The ball hit one of the bumps set at regular intervals around the wheel. This sent it caroming randomly over the wheel until it finally came to rest in one of the 38 slots. From where I was sitting, I couldn't tell which number it had landed in.

"Twenty-two," the croupier said, "pay even and black."

Everyone at the table groaned, the two other bettors a little louder than Robin and myself.

The dealer placed a fancy marker down on the empty spot marked twenty-two. With two quick swipes of her arms she cleared all the chips off the betting surface and began sorting them.

The woman in the green dress had no more chips in front of her, so she just picked up her complimentary drink and walked away. The man playing the numbers took a last swig of his Bud Light, grabbed his chips and turned to go.

The dealer looked up, but didn't stop sorting. "Sir, can I swap those chips out for you?"

The man angrily tossed them at the dealer and walked away. They landed in front of her, mixing with the other losing chips. She turned to look at the pit boss. He nodded his head. She took the three chips and added them to the stack. She then took three regular \$1 chips, sharply tapped them against the side of the table and dropped them in the tip box.

"Place your bets," she said to no one in particular.

We continued playing. For the next half hour Robin and I took turns placing five dollar bets. We mostly lost, but the occasional hit let us stay pretty close to even. We were down to about 80 dollars before another player decided to take a seat next to my wife.

He was tall, maybe 6'4", with wavy blond hair cut just off his collar, a closed cropped goatee and steel blue eyes. He looked Mediterranean to me, maybe northern Italy? He wore black designer jeans that were just a little too tight, not that I was looking, and a light blue paisley shirt with its long sleeves rolled up past his elbows.

He threw down five one hundred dollar bills and a platinum player's club card. He asked the dealer for a mix of \$5 and \$25 chips. While the dealer counted out his chips, and the pit boss entered his player's card into the computer, he turned to Robin and offered her his hand.

"Hi, I'm Scott," he said.

"And I'm Robin," my wife answered as she shook his hand. I was busy placing our next round of bets and I hadn't been paying too much attention.

"You here alone?" he asked.

"Oh no," Robin said somewhat hesitantly. "I'm here with my husband." She motioned toward me with her hand.

Scott stretched across the corner of the table, offering his hand to me. "I'm very sorry," he said. "Don't want you thinking I'm hitting on your wife."

"No problem," I said as I shook his hand. He had a firm, strong grip, that I tried to return in kind.

"You don't mind if I sit here, do you?"

"Of course not," my wife said. "Gambling's more fun with more people."

The pit boss, a short, thin man in his late 50's, came back to the table. "Welcome back Mr. Salvatore," he said as he handed back Scott's player's club card. "Good luck, and if you need anything, just ask."

Italian, just like I thought.

We continued making our little five dollar bets, winning just enough to keep us at the table without running out our stake. Scott was making larger bets and was losing quite a bit. He pulled out his bank roll again and peeled off another five hundred dollars. They must love having him play here.

"So, I never did catch your name," he said to me while the croupier was getting his chips.

"Oh, sorry. I'm Peter."

"So, Peter, where are you and Robin from?"

"Phoenix," I said.

"Well, we live there now," my wife said, "I was born in New Jersey but moved to Arizona for school."

"I like Phoenix," Scott said. "Nice city, but it's the weather I really love."

"No argument here," I said.

"So where are you from?" Robin asked. She normally didn't chat up complete strangers. I looked her way, but she was looking at Scott.

"I'm from L.A., but right now I'm living in Kansas City, on the Missouri side. I own a string of health clubs in Southern California and just opened two new locations in KC. I'll be living out there for another six months or so til I can get things up and running."

We kept playing and chatting. I talked about how much I enjoyed growing up in Arizona. Scott went on about all the trips he took, checking out various other spas and gyms getting ideas for his own locations.

Robin didn't say much, she just seemed to hang on to every word that Scott said. I started to feel a little jealous. Since we were in Vegas for our anniversary, I felt Robin should have been paying more attention to me.

On the other hand, I couldn't deny the fact that Scott did have a certain charisma. He sold himself and his businesses well. That kept me from getting too worked up by Robin's interest.

After about an hour and half, Robin and I found our stake was down to 50 bucks. I was getting bored with the game and thought about trying something else.

"Wanna cut our losses and head over to P.F. Chang's for dinner?" I asked my wife.

Robin looked away from Scott and toward me. "Sounds like an idea," Robin said, with just a trace of hesitation. "How about one more bet?"

Looking back on it, I should have said no. I should have said we could save the 50 dollars for tomorrow's stake. But I didn't. Instead I began to spread out another five dollars on the board.

"Sorry to see you two go," Scott said. "but if this is your last bet, why not make it count?"

"What?" my wife and I said in unison.

"Go for broke. Bet it all on one number. I'll bet with you."

I looked at the stack of chips in front of me, then at my wife. "A hundred dollars was our limit," she said, "Why not take a shot? Pick a number."

I was completely shocked. Robin was no penny-pincher, but she was never a high roller either. In fact, she was the one to suggest our daily lose limit. I looked at Scott; he just shrugged his shoulders. My wife looked at me expectantly, waiting for my reply. Her eyes open just a little too wide. She wanted this bet. She wanted to risk 50 dollars on the instigation of a man we had just met. It was a bet we were surely going to lose.

"Fine," I said. I was hoping a huge losing bet would end my wife's developing crush with Scott.

Robin's eyes lit up. She turned to our new friend and asked him, "What's your number going to be?"

I was trying to think of number to bet on. I looked at the handy tote board all modern casinos use to track the recent winning numbers. I figured I'd choose one that was due.

"I don't know," Scott said. "Why don't you pick one for me, Robin."

"Thirty-one," she said without hesitation.

Thirty-one, I thought. I wasn't feeling too good about my wife sharing our lucky number with a stranger.

"Thirty-one it is," Scott said, and he placed 4 green chips down on 31, a hundred dollar bet.

Whatever doubts I had were quickly washed away by the adrenaline released into my bloodstream. Here was a complete stranger putting up a c-note based on my wife's suggestion. I couldn't put the money down on any other number; I didn't want to look like a coward in front of Robin.

I slid my stack of chips to the dealer and told her to put it all on 31. She deftly counted down the stacks and put two green chips on the board. The she let the little white ball loose and set in motion a series of events that would change my life forever.

I slid five chips to the cashier, a yellow, a purple, and three black. She gave me 18 hundred dollars, more than what I made back home in a week. As the woman was counting out the bills my wife was behind me talking to Scott.

"I can't believe we won," she said. "We've never won that much money on one bet." My wife was so excited, hopping up and down, she had to grab Scott's elbow to keep from falling over.

"Wow, you really are excited," he said. Scott smiled at me and shrugged again, as if to signal he didn't know what was going on, but he sure was enjoying it.

I moved away from the window to allow our new friend to cash in his winnings. My wife stayed by his side as the cashier counted out an even larger stack of hundreds. I should have found it odd that she seemed more excited about Scott's winnings than our own, but my own rush of adrenaline clouded my thinking.

"I guess this is where we part ways," I said, as the three of us walked away from the cashier windows. "I can truly say it's been a marvelous time." I looked at my wife and noted a slight disappointment in her eyes.

"We don't have to call it a night just yet," Scott said. "I'm kinda hungry myself. Why don't you two have dinner with me?"

I turned to my wife, hoping she would be as eager as I was to celebrate our win alone, just the two of us. Maybe order a bottle of champagne and some dinner from room service. But I saw a sparkle in her eyes that said she really wanted to continue the celebration with our new friend. If I forced the issue I knew our evening wouldn't end up the way I wanted it to, the two of us in bed, making love like teenagers, so I gave in.

I had to admit, even though I was getting a little jealous about all attention he was getting from my wife, Scott was charming. He had interesting stories to tell and he seemed like a great guy to watch a ball game with. As long as Robin was happy, I'd be happy.

"Cool with me," I said. "What about you, honey?" I let the question hang, giving Robin the chance to change her mind.

"It's too early to turn in," she said. I wasn't surprised; a little disappointed, but not really surprised.

"Okay, let's run our winnings up to the room." I turned to Scott and asked, "Where did you want to meet?"

"You mentioned P.F. Chang's earlier, that sounds good," Scott said.

"Okay, we'll meet you there in 10 minutes." I took hold of Robin's hand and turned to head toward the room. I was abruptly pulled back. I looked at Robin with a raised eyebrow.

"You don't need my help to put the money in the room safe," she said. "I'll stay and keep Scott company."

"I'll go get us a table," Scott said and turned to head toward the restaurant.

"Don't be long," Robin said. She kissed me lightly on the cheek and turned to join him.

And now, I was starting to get just a little bit concerned. Was Scott charming my wife away from me? I found the thought frightening, but also a little arousing.

I quickly pushed the contradicting feelings aside and attempted to regain control of the situation.

I pulled Robin back roughly. Maybe a little bit too roughly. She had a shocked look in her eyes, then her brows began to furrow. She opened her mouth to say something, but I stopped her with a kiss. I forced my tongue into her mouth with more vigor than I ever had before. Any hint of anger or surprise quickly vanished. She returned my kiss with an intensity that surprised me.

"Get a room guys," Scott called back to us, his voice almost lost in the din of the casino.

We broke our kiss. "We have one," Robin said, giving me a wink. "I love you," she whispered into my ear. "More than you could ever know."

"Oh, but I do know," I replied.

She turned and hurried away to catch up with Scott. I couldn't help but notice a flirty skip to her steps. I wanted her so badly at that moment and my cock was embarrassingly hard. I wanted her and she was off with another man. The emotions that flooded my body could easily drown me. I needed to get away, to think.

I looked at my phone. It was only 8:15. The night was young and we had to spend it with our new friend. Part of me was jealous, part excited. My wife wanted to spend a few minutes alone with him, and I couldn't understand it. There were no easy answers to quell the questions in my head. So I set them aside and went up to our room.

I slid the room key into the slot above the door handle and waited. A yellow light blinked twice. What the heck. I tried again, with a constant forceful thrust, in and out. This time the green light came on and I heard the locking mechanism disengage.

I went in and looked around. In our excitement to get to the casino we hadn't unpacked anything. Our suitcases were sitting in front of the door on the far side of the living area that could be opened to connect to the room next to ours.

I pulled a beer out of the minibar and sat down on the couch. I propped my feet up on the glass coffee table, knocking off a few of the promotional pamphlets highlighting the many supposedly fun activities that Vegas had to offer, as if anyone came to Vegas for more than gambling and drinking.

I didn't like leaving my wife alone with Scott for any longer than necessary, but I had to resolve some of these opposing emotions I was experiencing.

Mostly I was feeling jealous that Scott was getting so much attention. It was like I was a fucking 12-year-old kid again, crying about the local bully stealing my bike. I had to grow up. Beyond the rising anxiety I also found my ego boosted by having such a beautiful and interesting wife. A woman other men could only dream of being with.

My mind was racing and my stomach was spinning cartwheels. This win wasn't going to change our lives, but it did mean we could afford to let loose this trip. Gamble a little more, eat at a few fancy restaurants.

"We can really splurge," I said to myself as I looked at the \$10 can of Bud in my hand.

I knew we could be having even more fun if I didn't have to spend most of the days attending workshops and seminars. At least Thursday, our anniversary, was a free day.

What I really wanted right now was to take my wife to bed. I wanted to turn those 18 hundred dollar bills into ones and fives, toss them on the bed and make love to her on top of it, like in the movies. Stupid, I know. While I was up here alone with the cash and my carnal thoughts, my wife was downstairs getting to know a total stranger a little bit better.

The sooner I got back the sooner the night would end and we could start celebrating alone. I got up and put the wad of bills in the small room safe inside the bedroom closet.

As I was leaving the room I took a moment to look back. The room was dark save for the few rays of neon light that were able to break through the gaps in the curtains. The red, green and blue lights blinked and danced along the edges of the window creating a rainbow halo around the blackness it contained. The lights beckoned, but it was the blackness that drew my attention. A void that called to me. The unknown feelings that were just then awakening. Feelings I could not yet name.

I don't know how long I stood there, staring into that void, but I was finally roused from my daze when the door next to ours opened. Out came a tall black man in a well cut suit over a dark blue shirt. The suitcase he

dragged behind indicated he was checking out. We nodded at each other, briefly breaking our own private thoughts to recognize each other's existence.

I was about to say hello when the man cursed under his breath and went back into his room. Perhaps to retrieve some toiletry or maybe a valuable watch or necklace left in the room's safe. Either way I found myself alone once again. I pulled the door to my room closed and made my way down to the restaurant to rejoin Robin and Scott.

I found them sitting at the bar, sipping drinks and sharing an appetizer. If she hadn't been my wife, I'd say they made a beautiful couple. As I made my way through the crowded restaurant I saw Scott lean in and say something into Robin's ear. She gave an instant laugh and placed her hand on his forearm. It was a simple gesture that sent a fresh wave of jealousy down my spine. She looked up, almost guiltily, and looked around the restaurant. Our eyes met and with a smile, Robin made everything better.

She waved me over. "What took you so long?" she asked.

"I had a beer," I said. "Didn't think we'd get seated right away."

"We could have had a table a few minutes ago," Scott said, "but I asked for one outside on the patio. Shouldn't be too long."

"Scott was just telling me about the houses he owns," Robin said again grabbing his arm. "He lives on the ocean. That would be so amazing."

"Waterfront property," I said. "Pretty impressive."

"Yeah, I made a little money with tech stocks in the nineties. Got out before the first bust."

"You still in stocks?" I asked.

"Nah. Unless you run a hedge fund with lots of capital it's just too risky. I'd rather throw my money away on blackjack or craps. At least the casinos play fair. They tell you up front the odds are against you. I own a few shares but it's the health clubs that keep me in the high roller lifestyle."

I was about to ask him what stocks he was in now when the small buzzer in front of my wife went off, announcing that our table was ready.

We followed the hostess outside to the crowded patio. Our table was against the railing. The Aria and Cosmopolitan Resorts across Las Vegas Blvd made a beautiful backdrop to our people-watching. The hostess saw I didn't have a drink in my hand and asked if she could get me anything from the bar. Robin was drinking a mojito and it looked like Scott was halfway through a tumbler of whiskey.

"Can you bring me a gin and tonic with a slice of lime? Well is fine."

I was hungry so I started browsing through the menu. I already had one beer on an empty stomach so getting something to eat was of the utmost importance to me. Robin, having had the opportunity to share an appetizer, decided to keep the conversation going. "So Scott, tell Peter 'bout the spas. You gotta hear about his spas."

"Sure, Scott, tell me about your spas." I said never looking up from the menu. I don't work out much. We have a treadmill and a few weights at home. I walk a couple miles three days a week. Keeps me healthy. I was never one to go for big muscles. It was hard enough for me to just keep off the love handles. I do pretty well and Robin didn't seem to mind.

"So I have the two gyms in L.A. Mostly muscle heads working the weights to impress their girlfriends. My locations in KC are more upscale. They'll cater to soccer moms trying to maintain their MILF status." My wife snickered at the comment. I was surprised she knew what the term meant.

As Scott continued describing his business, I found myself drawn into the conversation despite my lack of interest.

I was starting to see what Robin found so intriguing about this man. I didn't like it, but I understood it.

"We'll have massage and aromatherapy to go along with the rowing machines and yoga classes."

"That sounds like a lot of work," Robin said. "Keeping all these places running."

"That's why it's important to hire the right managers. I expect the best from my people but I also pay well. I don't cut corners."

"If I've done my job right each location should be up and running without me in six or seven months. All it takes after that is a visit every year or so, just to let my employees know I'm involved, but not too involved."

Our waitress finally arrived with my drink. "Are you three ready to order?"

"I don't know about those two, but I sure am," I said. I ordered the crispy honey shrimp with a side of garlic noodles. My wife ordered sweet and sour pork; our new friend got the beef with broccoli.

"Robin told me you're a veterinarian," Scott said. "That sounds like fun."

"Yeah, I like it."

"Robin said you don't have any kids, what about pets?"

"I love animals, but no we don't own any. Robin's very allergic to cat dander and I'm not much of a dog person. That's what makes my job so great. I get to visit with hundreds of different animals, pamper them, make them well then send them home to their owners who have to feed them, take them for walks and clean up their poop."

"Sounds like a great life. So you're in Vegas for business or pleasure?"

"A little of both," I said. "I'm here for the North American Veterinarian Conference and my wife is here so we can celebrate our anniversary."

"Your anniversary, huh? Robin didn't tell me that."

"Yeah, three years this Thursday," I said looking at my wife, who was looking at Scott. "Three wondrous years."

I tapped her on the shoulder. She turned to me and I kissed her on the lips. She returned the kiss.

"Yes, three wondrous years," she added.

We continued talking, watching the people passing by. Laughing at some of the stranger outfits we saw. At one point a man dressed all in silver, with silver painted skin, set up a box across from where we sat. He stood still as a statue and let people take pictures with him for tips. Michael Jackson also passed by as did Elvis Presley, three times. Despite my better judgment, I found myself starting to like Scott. He was fun and very easy to talk to. The only downside was that my wife seemed to like him a little too much.

Our conversation slowed when our meals arrived. I was too hungry to talk and just dived in. Robin and Scott did make a little small talk. Robin talking about her love of the Arizona desert and Scott giving us the scoop on his next business venture opening a new-agey spa in Sedona. I was just finishing my last piece of shrimp when Scott asked Robin what she was planning to do while I was busy with my "vet stuff."

"I don't know," she said. "I didn't make any plans. Sit by the pool, sipping a drink and just relaxing. Maybe check out some of the scenery."

"Like all the hot young men."

"Yeah, maybe." Robin smiled and gave Scott a friendly punch in the shoulder. I knew she appreciated looking at the male body. I'm no slouch but I wasn't interested in buffing up. It took a lot of work and free time to get and keep a body like Joe Manganiello.

About this time the waitress came back to see if anyone wanted dessert. Scott said he'd pass, but every time Robin and I ate at P.F. Chang's we ordered the Great Wall of Chocolate, six layers of delicious dark chocolate cake frosted and topped with chocolate chips, fresh berries and a tasty raspberry sauce.

"We'll have the Great Wall," my wife said.

"With two forks," I added.

"So Robin was telling me she went to Arizona State," Scott said after the waitress left to put in our order. "Is that where you met?"

"Oh no, I got my degree at the University of Arizona down in Tucson. Actually I was out of school when Robin was there."

"So how did you meet?"

"He saved my dog's life," Robin said.

"It was late. Being the new guy in the practice I got to close most nights. We were just about to lock up late one Friday night when in walked this beautiful brunette carrying a wet and bloody basset hound in her arms."

"Oh please, I must have been some sight, wet hair, streaky make-up and my blood-soaked dress."

"You were stunning despite the mess."

"I believe it," Scott added.

"Why do you think I made you leave the exam room," I said. "You were distracting me and I was having a hard time focusing."

"Did you always date your attractive patients?" Scott asked.

"None of my patients were attractive, but some of their owners were." Both Scott and Robin giggled. "But to answer your question, no. Most clients come in once when they get a new pet and then I rarely see them

again. With Robin I got lucky. Beasley needed several follow-up visits so I had plenty of time to get to know his owner." I took Robin's hand and kissed it lightly.

Our dessert arrived and Robin and I dug in. After a few bites I looked up and saw Scott looking out at the passing people.

"I'm sorry, we do make crummy dinner companions," I said. "Would you like a little cake?"

"It does look inviting, but no. Besides, I don't have a fork."

"Don't be silly," my wife said as she scooped up a bite of cake, swirled it in the raspberry sauce and offered it to Scott. She held out her fork, her free hand underneath the cake to catch any crumbs that might fall. "Here. Have a taste."

"Only if you insist." Scott offered his open mouth and Robin fed him the cake. A berry dropped from her fork and landed in her hand. Before she could move her hand away Scott sucked up the morsel. She giggled again and pulled back her hand just as his lips were about to brush against her open palm.

"I told you not to be silly," she said again. The playfulness was making me uncomfortable.

Scott just laughed. "That is good cake," he said. "Especially when fed to you by a beautiful woman." Robin just turned away with a smile and took another bite. It was dark, but I could still see she was blushing. She was so beautiful, I couldn't blame Scott for flirting with her, even if I didn't like it.

"Either of you two up for a night cap?" Scott asked. He seemed to be in town alone and was obviously looking for company. I looked at my phone; it was close to 10 o'clock. I looked at Robin as she took the last bite of cake. I could tell she wanted to spend a little more time with our friend, but I needed to be at the orientation meeting at eight in the morning.

I really didn't want to leave her down here, with a handsome stranger, even one as friendly as Scott seemed to be. I trusted my wife, but I wasn't as sure of him. Plus, I'd never get to sleep wondering what they were doing together.

"I'm beat," I said. "All this excitement has worn me out. Plus I need to get up early."

"Robin?" Scott said, turning to my wife.

She hesitated before answering. She looked at me for an answer but I didn't give her one. I wanted her to come back to the room with me, but I wasn't going to tell her what to do.

"I'd love to," she said as she looked me in the eye, "but Peter's right. It's late and we need to get up to the room. We haven't even unpacked yet."

"I understand," Scott said. He seemed disappointed but not too surprised. "It's just... I'm having such a good time."

"We'll, as they say, all good things must come to an end." It sounded cliché and I regretted the words the second they came out of my mouth.

"You're right," Scott said. He looked me in the eye and nodded. He knew why I was apprehensive.

My wife said nothing.

The waitress came with the bill. I reached for it but Scott grabbed it away. "Please let me get this."

"I can't let you," I said. "It's two of us and only one of you, plus we had dessert."

"No. I insist." I could feel the tension rise, just slightly. Although I doubted it would come to blows I didn't think I could let this stranger buy our meal.

"How about we split it down the middle," my wife said, trying to break up the argument.

I was having none of it. "Just let me sign it to our room. Besides, our per diem is covering most of it."

"Fine," Scott said, finally seeming to relent. "But let me get the tip."

"That's cool."

I took the bill and signed. I left the tip spot blank. Scott peeled a hundred dollar bill from his wad and dropped it in the tray.

"You want me to ask for some change?" I asked as we all got up to leave

"No, leave it."

Now the man was starting to get on my nerves.

"That's almost as much as the whole bill," I said.

"Come on, I just won three grand. I'm feeling generous."

Despite my initial reaction I had to agree; besides who was I to tell this man how to spend his money. "I guess you're right. Spreading the wealth does feel good." I pulled out a twenty of my own and added it to Scott's hundred.

"That's the spirit," he said. And all three of us had a good healthy laugh.

As we were walking out Robin stopped and asked me to take her picture in front of the larger than life replica of a terra cotta warrior that stood on the patio. As she posed beside the statue I pulled up the camera app on my phone. I took two pictures of her, one serious and one goofy.

"Let me get one of the two of you," Scott said. I handed him my cell and joined my wife. He took a shot and handed the phone back. "Now get one of me with Robin."

I thought it a bit odd, but I didn't say anything. He walked right up, as casual as could be and put his arm around her waist. It was a bit too friendly for my taste, but Robin was loving it. I framed up the couple and took the shot. It looked ok, but was a little blurry. "Hold it. Let me try another, that one didn't come out."

"Take your time, Pete," Scott called.

I took a few more pics and declared them good enough. Scott pulled out a business card and handed it to Robin.

"E-mail those pictures to me so I have something to remember you two by. I've had a great time."

"So have I - I mean we," my wife replied. "We've had a really good time as well."

"So long," Scott said. I offered my hand for a shake, but he brushed it aside and gave me a big strong hug. "And happy anniversary." He gave Robin a hug as well, adding a light kiss on the cheek before breaking it.

We watched Scott head away until he was lost in the crowd.

Robin was silent as we made our way back to the room. In the elevator she hummed to the muzak that played. I was puzzled. She didn't say anything about the winning, or the dinner, or spending the evening with Scott. Just a relaxed quiet.

All that changed when our room door closed behind us. She turned to me, grabbed my face and planted a big wet kiss square on my mouth. Her tongue had a life of its own as she forced it between my lips. She pulled me to the bed, tearing at my clothes as she went.

"Get undressed," she commanded.

I wasted no time complying. Usually it takes a little time to warm Robin up, a little petting or oral ministrations. Before I was done pulling my pants off my wife was totally naked and spread out before me on the bed. Her legs out wide, her pussy lips open and dripping wet.

"You look delicious," I said. "I can't wait to taste you."

I moved to dive between her thighs to taste her wetness but Robin would have none of it. She grabbed me by the hair and pulled me up. I had no choice but to quickly crawl over her.

"No," she said. "I want you inside me. Now."

"You don't need to ask twice."

With one stroke I was in. All the way in.

I was so wet for him. With one thrust of his cock he was in me. No foreplay was needed, or wanted. I closed my eyes and concentrated on the pleasure that flowed through my loins. The tensions of hours of desire unleashed in a few moments of passion. When he released his seed into me I came harder than I could ever remember.

After, I felt a little ashamed. I could never tell Peter.

Chapter 2

I was walking naked through the convention halls. I was conscious of my nakedness but no one else seemed to care. My guilt was my own. I tried to find something to cover myself with, a coat or a towel maybe but there were none to be found. Then I started to get an erection and shit was getting real. Embarrassment times 10. I think I was getting hard less from sexual excitement and more from having to pee really badly. And what do you know, there was no rest room in sight. I was contemplating just letting it flow where I stood. Then the alarm went off, and I was awoken from my dreamy torment with a raging case of morning wood.

I hit the off button and crawled out of bed. My head was pounding. I was groggy and I really needed to pee. After I finished my business at the loo I went back to check up on my wife.

She was sprawled out on her side of the king sized bed, her brown tresses splayed out around her head like a royal mane, her natural B-cup breasts exposed and laying flat against her chest. Her nipples were hard from the air conditioned room. The lower half of her body was covered by the bed sheet. She looked divinely beautiful, like an angel who lost her wings. Her face, serene. I wanted to rouse her from her sleep and make love to her. Not like the fucking we did last night. No, I wanted to take my time, to slowly and gently explore every inch of her peachy soft skin. To kiss and taste all her special parts.

Then I looked at the clock and saw I had just an hour to get down to the Sunset Hall for orientation. I needed to pick up my badge and get the final schedule for all the week's classes and events. I knew today and tomorrow were packed. Luckily I was able to make sure my calendar was totally clear for Thursday.

I gave up any hope for a morning quickie and went back to the bathroom to get cleaned up. It took me about twenty minutes to shower, shave and brush my teeth. When I came out, naked except for a towel around my waist, Robin was sitting at the table in the main room, sipping a cup of Starbucks coffee and browsing her Android tablet. She was wearing

her red sports bra and a pair of green sweat pants. Give her a couple pompoms and she could have been a Christmas cheerleader.

"Whatcha doing?" I asked.

"Checking the news and catching up on my e-mail," she replied. "You want coffee?" She pointed to another Starbucks cup at the opposite end of the table.

"That was fast; I was only in the shower for a minute."

"More like half an hour. Anyway, there wasn't much of a line downstairs. Too early."

"Yeah, only vet nerds like me up this early today."

"And those gamblers who haven't gone to bed yet."

I took a sip of coffee. It was very hot. And tasted kinda nasty after brushing my teeth with minty toothpaste.

I dressed while we continued our conversation.

"I've got a pretty full schedule ahead of me today and tomorrow," I said. "I think every minute's filled from 8 til 4. They're even having a special lunch sponsored by some pet food company. Vita-Vet I think."

"Hope they're not catering it as well." We both laughed.

"Actually that might be preferable to some of the chicken breasts I've eaten at these conventions. I hope you're okay spending the day alone. I'll make it up to you this evening."

"Don't worry, dear. I knew what I was getting into."

"At least we got away from Phoenix."

"Traded one desert for another."

"But this one has better shows."

"Yeah." Robin took another sip of coffee.

"So what are your plans for the afternoon?" I asked.

"I am going down to the gym after you leave. Do the treadmill and maybe have a quick massage. I wanted to do some shopping at Crystals across the strip."

"I'll leave you a couple hundred from our stash if you want to do some gambling."

"Thanks," she said with a smile.

"Crazy night last night, huh?"

"I know. Winning almost two grand?"

"Don't forget about meeting Scott," I said.

"How could I. He's interesting and quite a talker. He's also pretty gorgeous in a rough and manly way."

"Unlike me?"

"Don't be silly. I wouldn't have married you if I didn't think you were handsome."

"Thanks, I think."

"By the way, can you send me those pictures we took last night? We promised to send them."

"Sure," I said. "So what did you and Scott talk about when I went up to the room?"

I was finished dressing, a pair of black Dockers and a neon green Greg Normal polo shirt. I liked standing out in a crowd. I pulled out my phone

and emailed the pix to Robin's gmail account.

"Oh, just small talk. He told me about his business, bragging about the view from his living room window, looking out over the Pacific. He asked me about what I did for a living and I told him about working at the little boutique down in Tempe. Nothing important. Oh there you go. I got the pics, I'll send them to him later today,"

Just then I noticed how late it was getting, 7:55. "Crap," I said. "I've only got five minutes to get downstairs."

"I doubt they'll start without you."

We shared a kiss at the door.

"I really hate leaving you like this," I said. "Be good while I'm gone."

"No promises," she said.

No promises indeed.

The conference rooms were on the mezzanine level, up the escalators from the casino floor. When I got to the Sunset room it was packed. The outer perimeter was ringed with tables labeled with alphabetical ranges. Starting just to the left of the entrance with A - AL running all the way around ending at the table to the right with X - Z.

The line at the table marked W – Wil was five or six people deep. It took me another fifteen minutes to make it to the front of the line.

"Dr. Wilkenson," said a pretty black girl in a black skirt and white blouse. "Here you go." She handed me a thick white envelop with the name

of the conference printed on the front.

"You're one of the last. If you hurry you might still be able to grab a bite to eat before your first event."

I said thanks and walked away. I pulled on the lanyard with my badge attached and looked at it. Dr. Peter Wilkenson, D.V.M. After seven years of practice I still haven't gotten used to being a doctor. In my mind I'm just another dopey kid who likes animals but I can also cut them open and stitch them back up.

My first class was Feline Dentistry in conference room C. Our office in Phoenix was getting ready to expand into a full fledged Animal Hospital, complete with three surgical units. We were also planning to expand our other services and animal dentistry was one of those areas.

The room was full when I entered. I didn't get to grab any pastries but I was able to snag another cup of coffee. I spotted one of the few remaining seats at a table in the back next to a young Asian woman. Her black hair touched her collar in front and was tapered short towards the back. She wore a blue skirt with a pink polo shirt. "Seattle Animal Shelter" was embroidered above her left breast. According her badge she was Dr. Kelly Cho.

I set down my cup of coffee and whispered, "Mind if I sit here?"

"Course not," she said. She didn't look up at me; instead she kept her face down, scribbling notes on the yellow legal pad in front of her. It looked like she had already filled two whole pages and was beginning a third.

I looked to the front of the room. The seminar's speaker was just finished setting up his slide show. I looked down again at Dr. Cho's note pad. "I miss much?" I asked.

"No, the presentation hasn't started yet." She finally looked up at me and smiled. Her blue eyes took a quick scan of my body, not that she could see much since I was sitting down. I felt I was being judged even before we got

a chance to exchange names. "What made you think you missed anything?" she asked.

I glanced down at the pad in front of her.

"Oh this," she said seeing where I was looking. "It's just my pre-lecture notes, mostly points from the literature and my own experience. I've also got a few questions I'm hoping to get answers to. I just like to be prepared."

"My name is Peter Wilkenson," I said.

"I'm Kelly Cho. Nice meeting you."

Our conversation was cut short when the lights dimmed and the lecture started. I learned a lot of new information over the next hour and a half. The presentation began with the usual, getting owners to pay more attention to their pet's teeth. Buying the right food and encouraging dental maintenance. It may be hard brushing a cat's teeth on a routine basis, but it could save a big headache and lots of money down the road. And of course you can't get through one of these seminars without the sales pitch. The speaker introduced a new line of equipment he claimed would make oral surgery easier and safer. It looked promising but I'd need more information.

The lights came up and the room erupted with the sound of a hundred or more chairs being drawn across the floor. I looked at my phone and saw I had five minutes to get to my next seminar.

"So where you heading next?" I asked Dr. Cho as we packed up our papers and notes.

"I'm off to the class on New Treatments for Ticks, Fleas and other Parasites. We get a lot of calls for that at my clinic. Stray animals, you know."

"I wanted to go to that, but I'm heading to the seminar on selling Pet Health Insurance. Too many clients come in with no way to pay. I can't turn them away, but it's costing us lots of money."

"Well good luck with that," she said as she turned to go.

"Will I see you again?" I asked. I always liked making new contacts at these conventions and I was hoping to get to know Dr. Cho better. "Maybe at the catered lunch?"

"Oh, I'm not going to that," she said. "My husband's here and I'm meeting him downstairs for lunch."

"I thought the lunch was mandatory?"

"Nothing here is mandatory," she said laughing. "It's not like they take attendance."

"I never thought of it that way." I reached into my pocket and pulled out one of my business cards. "Here take this. If you ever need a contact in Arizona don't hesitate to call me."

She thanked me as she took the card. She tore off a piece of her notepad and scribbled an e-mail address.

"I need to order more of my own cards, but you can reach me here."

I took the scrap of paper and wrote her name on it. We said our good-byes and headed our separate ways.

As I headed towards the next meeting I texted Robin.

-Hey hon, my lunch hour is free, meet me at the Burger bar.

I waited for a response but it didn't come right away. Robin doesn't keep her phone with her all the time. I just hoped she'd see my message in the next half hour.

The Pet Insurance seminar was pure sales pitch. It was like they were trying to get us, the vets, to buy in. I liked some of the ideas but not the company making the hard sell. I took the info but figured we'd go with a different carrier.

The seminar ended at exactly noon and everyone began to make their way to the banquet room for the catered lunch. It was free food, if you didn't mind the sales pitch that went along with it. I, on the other hand, would much rather spend my free time with my wife.

I headed down to BurGR, a newish burger joint at Planet Hollywood opened by Gordon Ramsey. The atmosphere was casual and even if there was a line for getting a table there was almost always a seat at the bar. I hadn't eaten there yet, but it did get good reviews and it was close, near the main casino entrance.

It was just my luck that when I arrived the place was packed, there was a thirty-minute wait for a seat and even all the bar stools were taken. I scanned the crowd and didn't see Robin anywhere. I looked at my phone. She hadn't texted back. I went up to the room hoping she was there.

The green light came on immediately when I slid my key card into the slot on our room door.

"Surprise honey," I called out. Silence met me as I entered the room. I looked around. Our breakfast mess had been cleared away. I looked into the bedroom and found the bed made. In the bathroom the dirty towels and wash clothes had been removed and fresh folded ones put in their place. Housekeeping had been here, but Robin wasn't.

Just then I felt a short buzz in my pocket. It was a text from Robin.

-Sorry I missed your text. Met up with Scott.

Why didn't she text me back sooner? I could have made other plans. And standing me up for Scott? That stung a bit. I wasn't so much mad as just disappointed. I really couldn't blame her for trying to find someone to spend the off hours with.

-Just glad you're okay. Where are you?

It only took a few seconds to get a reply.

- Shopping. Can't wait to show you what i bought.

**-K. Gotta run and try to get something quick to eat. Done at 4.
Where do we meet?**

This time the reply took a little longer.

-Not sure. I'll text you later. Bye.

-Bye to U. Luv ya.

A quick reply back.

-Love U 2

I put away my phone and headed back downstairs. I was able to pick up a quick sandwich and chips and make it to my next meeting. It was New Surgical Techniques, with lots of slides. Just what you want to see while eating a sloppy meatball sandwich.

I made it through the next hour and a half without throwing up, and believe it or not I did find the presentation useful. There was a brief 15 minute break before the Trends in Oncology Treatments was to begin, so I headed to the men's room. As I was coming out I ran into a familiar face.

"Hey," I said, "aren't you staying in the room next to me?"

His name tag said Alex Spencer and he was the gentleman I almost ran into last night after dropping my money off in the room.

"No. I don't think so," he said. He looked at me a bit closer and a hint of recognition spread across his face. "Oh wait, you're in room 1919B, aren't you."

"Yeah."

"That makes sense now. Yeah I kinda remember you. My name is Alex. I'm here with Glossman Pharmaceuticals."

We shook hands.

"I'm Peter Wilkenson. So you aren't staying in the room next to mine?"

"Well I was, but now I'm in one of the posher suites. Our CEO couldn't make it so I upgraded myself to his room since it was already paid for."

"Lucky for you, I guess."

"Yeah, well, it was nice running into you. Again"

"Maybe I'll see you around."

I did end up seeing him again, ten minutes later when he hosted a panel on new cancer drugs coming onto the market. Again, lots of new information that was going to help our practice save more pet's lives, and earn more money. After the panel ended I exchanged business cards with Alex. I told him about our expansion plans and he said he'd work up an action agenda to help us get the ball rolling. Overall it was a profitable encounter.

It was so profitable that I didn't have time to obsess about how my wife was spending her afternoon with another man, a rich and handsome other man. I know I don't have rugged features, my skin burns instead of tans and I have started to develop love handles. My wife says she loves me for who I am, and I believe her. I just know that I am a very lucky man to have a smart, outgoing and beautiful wife. There's always a give and take in any relationship and between Robin and myself, I got the better end of the bargain. I just hoped she never had any regrets.

My pocket buzzed again.

-U done? It was my wife.

-Yeah, where are you?

-at the pool. Meet us there.

I went up to the room first. I wasn't going to go sit by the pool in my Dockers. I forgot to pack a bathing suit so I had to settle for a pair of blue cargo shorts. Kinda dorky, but they'd have to do.

I decided to take a leak before joining my wife at the pool. As I washed my hands I noticed a couple new hair styling products on the sink counter. I also saw a few shopping bags thrown on the couch. I could have gone through them to see what she had bought, but I figured I'd find out soon enough.

I texted Robin, - **heading down now. Order me a beer.**

-will do.

The Planet Hollywood Pleasure Pools were a sight to behold. They were located on the resort's roof overlooking the Las Vegas Strip. There were two of everything. Two large pools, two hot tubs, and two poolside bars. The weather was pleasant, in the upper 80s and there were a few people enjoying the water. Most of the people were lounging in the deck chairs, getting some sun and taking in the view. Every so often a group of two or three stunning women would parade around in very revealing bikinis trying to draw attention, and succeeding. For me, it was still a little too dry and breezy to go swimming. Getting into the water was fine, it was getting out that made my dick shrivel.

As I was looking around for Robin, I spotted a familiar woman standing at one of the poolside bars.

“Dr. Cho?” I said. “Fancy running into you out here.”

The vet from Seattle I had met earlier had traded her polo shirt and skirt combo for a sexy metallic black one-piece bathing suit, cut to pleasantly show off her ample bosom and butt.

She had been talking and sharing a drink with a rather handsome blond-haired man in neon blue swim trunks. She didn't seem to recognize me right away. Hearing my voice, she scanned the small crowd of people around her, looking for someone she might know.

“It's me, Dr. Wilkenson,” I said, extending my hand, “from the seminar this morning.”

A smile formed on her face as she realized who I was.

“Peter!” she said, pushing my hand away and enveloping me in a full, friendly hug. “Sorry, I didn't recognize you. My mind is elsewhere.”

She broke our embrace and introduced her companion. “This is Jonathan.”

We shook hands. His grip was strong, but I easily held my own. What is it about men, trying to assert dominance when first meeting? It wasn't like I was looking to steal his wife away and add her to my harem.

“So, you're Kelly's husband,” I said. “Enjoying a little R and R while she's hard at work?”

“Uh, no,” Jonathan said as he released my hand. “Kelly and I just met.”

“We're just enjoying each other's company,” Kelly said.

My face must have turned 20 shades of red. “I'm sorry, I just assumed -”

“Don't worry about it,” Kelly said. “It happens all the time.”

An odd thing to say, but I let it pass.

She continued, “I'd love to stay and chat some more, but we're off to meet up with my husband.” She paused for a second, looking me up and down. I was about to tell her I, too, had to find my spouse but before I could open my mouth, she asked, “Would you like to join us for drinks up in my room?”

Another odd question, but my mind was also elsewhere at the time. I begged off.

“Too bad, would have been fun. I guess I'll see you tomorrow?”

"I'm sure you will," I said.

I watched Kelly and Jonathan walk off together, hand in hand. My eyes lingered on her invitingly plump ass. Even though I loved my wife's svelte body, I did appreciate a woman with a full figure.

I looked around some more and still could not spot Robin. It was Scott I saw first. He was sitting on the far edge of pool, dangling his feet into the water. He wore a pair of red swim trunks and a blue tank top with a parrot on the front. One hand held a beer, the other rested on the thigh of a beautiful short-haired woman sitting next to him.

She wore a black two piece bathing suit: bikini bottoms and a bandeau top that was just large enough to decently cover her breasts. Her brown hair was short and spiky. She looked very cute, almost elfin. I was wondering where Robin was, when I realized I was looking right at her.

About this time she looked up and saw me. A smile lit up her face. She held up a bottle of Corona and waved me over.

I was stunned. She had cut off her beautiful long hair. And the bathing suit was the kicker. She usually always wore a one piece, and when she did go for a two piece it was usually more modest, with a full top and some light fabric covering her trim tummy.

The Robin who stood before me now was far from modest. She greeted me with a forceful kiss, her tongue briefly exploring my mouth. My cock began to stir and I quickly pulled away before I got a full-fledged hard-on. She offered me the beer and I took a swig and stood back so I could take in my wife's new look.

She took the opportunity to do some poses. "What do you think?" she asked. She had her hands on her hips, breasts thrust out and head tossed back. I always thought Robin had a great body, but I kinda liked being the only one who saw this much of it.

"Truthfully," I said. "I loved the long hair." I paused for effect. My wife began to pout. "But this short style makes you look ten years younger. It's

like I'm married to a twenty-something co-ed."

She laughed and gave me such a hearty hug, I almost spilled my beer.

"I see you've been busy," I said.

"Yeah. Worked out a bit this morning. Then I sent Scott the pics."

By this time our new friend had stood up.

"Nice to see you again," he said. We shook hands.

I turned to my wife and asked, "Didn't you get my text?"

"I didn't see it until almost 12:30. Scott and I had already finished lunch."

"Where did you go?"

"Mon Ami Gabi. It's a French street cafe down at the Paris Resort."

"The food is excellent," Scott said, "plus it has a great view of the Bellagio fountains."

"Nice," I said. "I got to view close up slides of a feline neutering procedure during my lunch."

"Sorry 'bout that," was all my wife could add.

"So what did you two do after lunch?"

"Shopping. Went to the mall across the street. Bought this suit," she waved her hands across her body. "You like?"

"Yeah, I do. Very sexy."

"Good, then you'll love the new dress I got for tonight."

"What's happening tonight?"

"We're going to a show."

"Which one?"

By this time we had moved to a couple of nearby recliners where Robin and Scott had set their belongings. I took another swig, killing my Corona. Scott got up.

"I'm going to get another beer," he said. "You want one?"

"Sure. You want anything, Robin?"

"No, I'm good. Already had two margaritas today. Need to pace myself."

Scott left to get the beers.

"So you didn't say what show we're going to."

"It's called Zumanity."

"Zumanity. That's an odd name."

"Scott recommended it," Robin said as she rummaged through her clutch. "Said it's an adult version of Cirque du Soleil."

"Like naked acrobatics?"

"Yeah, but much more. Very adult themes and a healthy take on human sexuality."

"Sounds interesting."

She pulled the tickets out of her purse. "Good, because we already got the tickets." She handed them to me. "It's couch seating. Very intimate and close to the stage."

I looked at the two tickets. "108 and 110? They just do even numbers?"

"Oh no. I must have given Scott the wrong ticket."

Wonderful, I thought. Another evening with Scott. I had to admit I was starting to get mad. Having my wife spend her free time with him was one thing. It wasn't really any of my business. Robin is free to spend her time with anyone she wants. I trust her completely. But sharing her during OUR time was really pushing it.

"Now don't get mad, Peter," Robin said, correctly reading the frown that had spread across my face. "I'm having fun, you seemed to be having fun last night, and Scott is having fun."

"You two talking about me behind my back?" Scott had returned with our beers.

"We'll finish this later," I said. "Thanks for the beer."

"I didn't mean to interrupt anything. I'll leave you two alone if you want."

YES, I would love it if you left us alone, like for the rest of the week. "No, you're fine," I lied.

I spent the next hour nursing my beer and my frustration. Robin and Scott took their drinks over to one of the hot tubs. I wasn't dressed for the water so I just hung out watching the few swimmers who braved the pool. I also started watching the younger girls in the skimpy bikinis showing off their tight bods. But then I would remember my Robin, showing off her own.

I always thought she was gorgeous before, but maybe I didn't say it enough. Did she really not get the encouragement she needed from me? Did she need someone else to validate her self-worth? I took another swig of beer and just kept chugging until it was all gone.

"I need something stronger," I said to myself. By the time I returned with a plastic tumbler of Jameson, Robin and Scott were out of the hot tub and toweling off.

"There you are," Scott said looking up. "We wondered where you got off to."

"Just getting another drink." My stomach was starting to do somersaults. Maybe I should slow down the drinking. I took another sip.

"The show starts at 7:30," my wife said, "but the ticket agent said we want to be at the theater by seven."

I looked at my phone. It was 5:45. "We should have time to grab a quick bite."

"Ok. I gotta get back to my room and change," Scott said. "I'm staying at the Aria. I'll meet you two at the theater around seven-ish."

That was a nice surprise. At least I'd get to spend an hour or so alone with my wife.

"That sounds great," I said with just a little too much enthusiasm. I don't know if Scott noticed, but Robin did. She shot me a look.

"Ok, see ya in an hour," she said. She gave him a light kiss on the cheek before he left.

Like the previous night, we rode up the elevator to our room in complete silence, but unlike then, I doubted this trip would end with us fucking like animals. There were just too many issues that needed to be addressed, or, at least I thought so. I wasn't sure about Robin and what was going on in her mind.

We were both standing in the back of the elevator car, staring straight ahead. I turned to look at her, but she didn't move. I wanted to see her eyes.

I had to see her eyes. I'd known her long enough to be able to tell her general disposition just by looking into her eyes.

For a brief moment I was able to catch her gaze in the polished elevator doors. Before she looked away, I saw a woman who was frightened and a little unsure of herself. I was about to ask her what was wrong when the doors opened and she hurriedly walked out into the hall.

I was finally able to ask my question when we got to the room.

"Robin, honey, I was really looking forward to some us-time this week."

She didn't answer right away, but instead wasted no time in turning on the hot water and stepping into the shower. I watched her close her eyes and let the steaming spray strike her face and cascade down her body. After a short silence, she began to remove her bathing suit and finally speak to me.

"I know love. I want to spend time alone with you too, but I also want to spend time with Scott."

"But you did spend time with him, this afternoon."

"It's just that we were having such a good time, I didn't want - I don't want it to end."

"Look, you know I don't have any problem with you having male friends. I trust you."

Suddenly she turned sharply towards me, a look of anger in her eyes. "Why wouldn't you trust me?" I could make out just a hint of venom in her words. "Actually, why would you? Am I too safe? Too boring? Do I always do the right thing?"

"Honey, you're starting to scare me."

"Good."

I just looked at her as she lathered up to wash the chlorine from her suit and skin. I figured she was finished, so I went into the bedroom to change

into something a little more formal. I decided to go with a pair of black dress slacks and a light blue long sleeve shirt. It may be in the 80s right now, but at night the desert can get plenty chilly. I'd be glad for the long sleeves then. I poked my head into the bathroom

"I'm going to grab something to eat downstairs, you want anything?"

Robin was standing in front of the sink. A towel, that would usually be wrapped around her head to dry her hair, was instead wrapped around her body. She wiped the condensation off the mirror with a cool damp washcloth so she could re-apply her makeup.

"Yeah, be a dear and get me a salad, with grilled chicken if you can."

Her anger seemed to be gone, or at least dissipated a bit. I stood behind her and wrapped my arms around her. It felt so good just to hold her. We shared a brief moment. She reached her hand up to gently stroke the side of my face. I reached my fingers under the towel to caress her breasts. I could feel the blood flow to my cock. I really wanted to make love my wife right now. With my other hand I reached between her thighs to touch her sex. I sensed a hint of wetness. Was it water, or Robin's arousal? I never found out. My movement had broken the spell.

Robin slapped my hand away. "Please dear, we don't have time. We have less than an hour to get over to the theater."

"It's only a block," I said. I knew we didn't have time. I knew the blocks were a mile long. I knew my wife was going to take another half hour to get ready, but I had to try. I wouldn't be able to forgive myself if I didn't.

All she had to do was turn around and look at me. The towel dropped away and she stood before me totally bare. She hugged me and even as she did my erection slowly deflated. My body had given up, knowing there would be no playtime just yet. I may have been put off now, but I didn't give up hope for a happy ending this evening.

I left the room and grabbed my wallet, making sure I had my room key with me. As the door slowly shut behind me, I heard her call out for me to

hurry back.

I was back in just under twenty minutes with two Caesar salads, one with grilled chicken, one with grilled shrimp.

It was a tricky maneuver to get my key card out and slide it into the slot while juggling the two salads. I was about to insert my key when the door slowly opened. I nearly dropped the salads at the vision that stood before me. I did drop my jaw.

"Damn," was all I could say.

She looked like a goddess. Divine. Wise as Athena and lovely as Aphrodite. She wore a tight black wraparound dress that showed off just enough cleavage to be sexy yet sophisticated. She had on a pair of high heel shoes that accentuated her already lovely legs.

She now stood eye to eye with me. And what beautiful eyes. Keen, sharp hazel eyes that I loved to get lost in. She had added a moderate amount of mascara and green eye shadow to help them stand out. Her lips, a deep ruby red I oh so wanted to kiss. I moved in, she moved back and for the second time I nearly lost our dinners.

"No, silly you'll ruin my makeup. I'll kiss you later."

"Promises."

"Don't smart mouth me young man," she said with a smile, giving me a light smack on the cheek. "Any more talk like that and you might be sleeping on the sofa tonight."

"You look stunning, Robin. That dress is amazing."

"I know."

"Where did you get it?"

"At a little boutique in the Shops at Crystals. 'Mona's Wardrobe' I think it's called."

"How much was it?"

Robin paused and took a bite of her salad. She slowly chewed it. She thoroughly chewed it. She took her time swallowing it. It was almost as if she didn't want to answer.

"Don't get mad," she said before taking another bite.

"I will get mad if you keep stalling."

She finished her bite and answered.

"Eighteen hundred dollars." Her eyes were still cast down, watching her fork play with what was left of her salad.

I got a lump in my throat. That was a lot of money. A shit load of money really. I felt that I should be mad but I really wasn't.

"We did win that much at the roulette wheel," I said. "I was planning on spreading that out over the next few days, maybe splurge on something really nice for our anniversary." Robin was silent, so I continued. "But hell, that dress is really nice. You look gorgeous in it. It's a wonderful anniversary gift."

After a moment Robin finally said something, "Don't be mad honey." I could barely hear her as she whispered into the remains of dinner. She had put her fork down and was no longer eating.

"How could I be mad? You saw something you wanted and you bought it. How could I be mad?"

Again near silence and another whisper.

"Don't be mad, Peter." Then came the gut punch. "Scott bought it for me."

Why do people give gifts? She thinks to herself, unable to express her true feelings to her husband. To get something in return is the obvious answer. When we trespass, we may offer a gift in return for forgiveness. When we need some assistance, we may offer a token for a favor. Even a gift given altruistically often results in pleasant feelings.

With every gift, deep down, we expect to receive.

What is Scott expecting?

Chapter 3

Robin finally looked up at me. Had she been crying? I wasn't sure. For a moment, my heart skipped a beat. She cared. Robin still cared about me, about us. All the other stuff just didn't matter. The dress was just a thing, pieces of sewn fabric that cost someone else an obscene amount of money.

I shook my head and returned Robin's gaze. I saw that her makeup was still perfect, pristine. There were no tears and the sadness I thought I saw had morphed into something more like a challenge.

"Peter, talk to me." my wife said. Her voice breaking the silence. "Are you mad?"

I looked down at her again. If she had been crying, she had stopped, and since her makeup was still pristine, I realized she hadn't been. I wanted her to be sad, heartbroken about how she might have hurt me. The fact that she was hesitant to tell me about the purchase indicated she knew I would be hurt. So what did it mean that she didn't seem to care? I'd tie my stomach up in knots worrying about it, trying to guess. The only way to find out for sure was to ask.

"Should I be, or more to the point, do you really care?"

"Of course I care, Peter," she said. A look of mild anger began to form on her face. "And no, you shouldn't."

"But you seemed to think I would be. Why didn't you tell me earlier that Scott was spending so much money on you?"

"It didn't seem to matter. We were having a good time and I think we're becoming good friends. The money issue just didn't come up."

I wanted to say how most men expect something when they spend that kind of money on a woman. It was sexist I know, but still a truth. I bit my tongue. I really didn't want to hurt my wife, even though I felt betrayed. I loved her. She was everything to me and I didn't want to lose her, but I was feeling her beginning to slip away.

"People don't spend that kind of money on someone they just met unless they have an ulterior motive," I said, trying to keep my comments gender neutral.

"It could have been worse; I also tried on a six thousand dollar dress." She gave me a hint of a smile, and my anger melted away. I don't know how she did it, but she got me to smile too.

"So are we okay?" she asked.

"I'd be lying if I said I wasn't a little mad. This anniversary trip isn't turning out like I expected. I didn't intend to share you with another man."

"Peter Wilkenson, I am not your property. You don't get to share me. I decide who I spend my time with."

"Robin you know I don't think you're my property."

"You're acting like I am."

"Okay, maybe I'm being selfish, but I really want to spend more time with you."

"I understand that Peter, don't you want me to have a good time?"

"Yes. I do."

"Then you need to understand you're starting to hurt me."

"But can't you see what you're doing to me?"

"No, Peter. You're doing it to yourself."

"What?"

"Do you believe I love you?"

"Yeah."

"Do you trust me?"

"Of course I do."

"Then you need to give me some space. I know what I'm doing. I'd never do anything I thought would come between us."

That was a rather ambiguous statement, but I kept my mouth shut. I looked at my phone, it was ten til seven.

"So are we good?" she asked again.

"We need to get going."

"Peter, that's not an answer."

"It's the best I can give right now."

She let out a heavy sigh. "I guess that will have to do. Can we call this a truce?"

"Sure. I'll be good this evening."

"Good," she said. She touched her cheek to mine and smacked her lips; a pretend kiss. "Get your wallet and let's go."

We quickly made our way to the Zumanity theater located at the New York, New York Casino Resort. Well, we moved as quickly as we could with Robin in her high heels. We weaved our way between and around the mass of humanity that crowded the Vegas sidewalks on any given night. Besides the tourists there were various folks who feed off them, from the benign costumed performers working for tips, or salesmen hawking time shares, to the less trustworthy con men with their three-card monte. Walking

from point A to point B was always an adventure in Vegas. That's why taxi cabs rule.

I didn't think we'd make it in time, but we did. We found Scott pacing around the lobby, looking at his watch. He looked relieved when he saw us.

"Great to see you guys, I was afraid you wouldn't make it."

"It's my fault, it took me longer to get ready than I thought," I said.

Scott didn't look like he was buying it. He appeared to want to make some sarcastic remark but stopped when he caught sight of my wife. He just looked at her without saying a word. His eyes glued to her's for a long moment, then glided down to scan her whole body.

"You look absolutely stunning," he said.

"Thank you," she said, giving him a curtsey.

"That dress is amazing," he said. "Where did you get it?"

"He knows," Robin said.

"Yes, I know," I added, "and I want to thank you. She looks wonderful in it."

I tried to grab her around the waist to pull her to my side, but I missed. She stumbled forward and had to reach out to Scott for support. She fell into his arms, their faces just inches apart. The moment held for what could have been an eternity. Their eyes locked. It looked like Robin was moving in for a kiss. I just stood there looking. She wouldn't let me kiss her for fear of messing up her lipstick, but here she was leaning in to Scott. My stomach did a small flip. I had to force myself to not get mad. 'Robin loves you,' I kept repeating in my head.

Before their lips could make contact, Scott's eyes caught mine. He pulled his face back while keeping Robin from falling.

"That was close," he said, breaking the spell. I wasn't sure if he was referring to the stumble or the kiss. I wasn't really sure it mattered. "Let's go inside and find our seats."

Robin turned and looked at me. "You coming?" she said, ignoring the near miss kiss.

"There's some neat interactive play between the performers and audience before the show begins," Scott said as he led us in. "Plus you do not want to walk in late, especially with our seats."

"So, you've seen this show before," I said.

"Yeah, actually this will be my third time."

We had our tickets scanned and were allowed into the inner lobby. I spied a long bar on the left. "I need a drink," I said. "You want anything Robin?"

"A white wine. How about you Scott?"

"Johnny Walker. Blue if they have it, Black if not."

I was about to say something sarcastic about buying him a \$60 shot of scotch, then I remembered Robin's dress. "Cool."

Robin took Scott's arm and he led her off towards the entrance to the theater.

"Fuck me," I whispered to myself. Earlier in the evening I was pissed that Scott was tagging along with us, now it was me doing the tagging. I really hoped Robin knew what she was doing.

"Let me have a glass of your house Chardonnay and a shot of Johnny Walker." I scanned the shelves, of course they had it. "Blue, with a couple ice chips."

The kid behind the bar moved quickly to get my order. He was dressed like a bartender with a pair of black pants and a black vest over a white

shirt, but the atmosphere was more like a movie theater concession stand. He poured the wine out of a soda gun. At least the scotch got poured out of a bottle.

"Anything else?" he asked.

"Yeah, I'll have a large ginger ale." My stomach was still bothering me. The ginger ale should help. "And give it a double shot of Jameson." If the soda didn't help, the whiskey would.

"Anything else?"

"That'll do."

"Okay, that'll be \$93.50."

Ninety bucks for three drinks. I really hoped they pay these performers well, I thought. I pulled out my billfold and gave the kid 6 twenties. "Keep the change."

"Thank you very much."

I collected my drinks and made my way to the theater. I had to carry my ticket between my teeth since my hands were full. An usher gently took the ticket. She looked to be about nineteen years old and wore an extra-large T-shirt with a design that made it appear she was wearing very skimpy lingerie.

"You're in a couch seat up front," she said. She looked at my burden. "I hope you're not here alone."

"No," I said. Despite how I was feeling inside, I laughed and replied, "Would be kinda sad if I was." It was sad, but in a different way.

I followed the girl to my seat. As we made our way through the dimly lit aisles I saw a few performers randomly roaming the crowd making sexual jokes and doing simple crude and rude acrobatic stunts. There was a shirtless, long haired Lothario coming on to a couple of women seated a few rows back from where we were passing. A rather heavysset woman,

wearing less clothing than my wife was earlier at the pool, made her way over and began hitting the man softly in his impeccable six pack abs. She also spit out a few unkind words to the targets of his affection. The crowd seems to love the act, knowing it was all in good fun.

"It seems someone is in your seat," she said as we approach a couch, up front, just below the main stage. Scott and Robin were sharing one couch. A portly middle age man sat alone in the couch next to Robin.

"No," I said. "Those are my dates."

The usher gave me an inquisitive look.

"Hey, don't judge me," I said with a smile.

She laughed. "You really get this show, don't you?"

I wanted to say this was my first time, but why tell the truth when a lie is so much more fun.

"Yeah, we do."

"Well here you go," she said. She left to find another patron to lead into this den of iniquity.

Scott and Robin looked to have been sharing a ribald joke. She gave him a playful slap on the thigh. "You're evil," my wife said with a grin. She looked up at me. "Oh good, you're back. I was getting thirsty." Robin took her wine and Scott's whiskey from my hand.

"I'm sorry, I'm in your seat." Scott said. He stood up after Robin passed him his drink.

"I didn't know how you took your scotch," I said, "so I just had them add a little ice."

I sat down on the couch next to my wife and took a sip of my drink. The soda did settle my stomach a bit, but I still felt a little queasy. Scott sat on the couch next to ours, near Robin and as far away from the lone sad man as

possible. Robin leaned over to say something to Scott and I felt a sick connection to that other man. I was here with two people, but I might as well have been alone. My stomach did another flip and I took another sip.

"Scott, tell Peter that joke you just told me," Robin said, giggling. She must have sensed my unease and wanted to include me in their group.

"Oh, I can't."

"Come on, you can tell me," I said.

"No, it's too crude."

"Really? You can tell my wife but you can't tell me?" I was starting to get a little angry.

"If you knew the joke, you'd understand why."

"Tell me," I said. I was trying not to sound too anxious. I was curious and just a little mad they could share something like a dirty joke between them but couldn't include me.

"No," Scott said firmly. "Robin, you tell it."

My wife looked at me, then back to Scott, then back to me. She giggled again.

The lights were beginning to dim. A beefy black man in tight white jeans who had been lazily lounging at a piano on stage began to play. A tall lanky white man, dressed in a black corset, fishnet stockings and top hat began to languidly parade around the stage. The show would be starting momentarily.

I elbowed Robin in the ribs. "Tell me the joke," I said.

She was watching the stage, but she turned to me. A wicked grin spread on her face. "Later," she said.

I knew Robin was not going to relent at that point, but I needed something. "Promise?" I asked.

"Yeah, I promise. Now hush, the show's starting."

To say that Zumanity is an adult version of Cirque du Soleil is an understatement. It had all the various types of acrobatics you'd expect from other shows, but with a kinky twist. Each act representing a different aspect of human sexuality. In one two men were locked in a small square cage. They begin to fight; they ripped each other's clothes off. Fighting turns to wrestling and then somehow they're passionately kissing. Although I consider myself strictly heterosexual, I found it intriguingly erotic.

In another act a fit black man and a blond white woman share a bathtub filled with what appeared to be milk. They were bathing topless.

I could go on, but I would recommend you just see the show.

Between the featured acts, there was a team of comedians who kept the audience entertained and aroused while the sets were changed.

It was during one of these breaks that I tried to sneak away for a pee break. Big mistake. As soon as I stood up I caught the attention of a pair of mimes who were creating anatomically correct balloon animals. They pointed at me and from somewhere in the rafters above the stage a beam of light appeared, targeted on me. I was stunned for a moment. The mimes started to make crude gestures. One pretending to hold his dick and peeing, the other began to laugh and the audience joined in.

I felt very embarrassed. I looked down at Robin. She couldn't help but giggle with the crowd. Scott wasn't laughing but he did shrug his shoulders. "I warned you," he said. I really didn't have many options. Getting mad was just childish. I could play along, but I didn't feel like it, so I just decided to ignore them.

I moved toward the exit, hoping the spotlight wouldn't follow me. Well it did. I tried to move as quickly as I could. I zigged and zagged down the aisles but the light was glued on me. I'm sure the operator knew every

possible path so I wasn't going to surprise them. When I was halfway to the exit the audience roared with laughter. I looked back and the mime who was simulating urination began to furiously jerk his fist up and down in front of his crouch.

Fuck, I wasn't going to live this one down. My stomach did another flip, this one worse than before.

I did finally make it to the bathroom to relieve myself. My stomach gurgled and I thought about trying to take a dump but I changed my mind. This show had to be close to over and I wanted to get back before the end.

Despite being ignored by my wife for most of the evening and enduring painful cramps, I was having a good time. She seemed to be happy and I couldn't fault her for that. The show was excellent, like nothing I'd ever seen before. A show that was sexy as hell, yet able to cater to just about everyone's tastes. As long as you had a reasonably open mind.

I did my business and headed back to my seat. I asked an usher for help. This time it was a young man. He had a perfect set of six-pack abs printed on his T-shirt. With no spotlight to guide the way he had to use his little flashlight. I thought I was going to get to my seat without any more embarrassment. Well, I was wrong.

Two surprises greeted me as I arrived at the seat. One I should have expected. While I was gone Scott had switched seats with me. He and Robin were sitting very close and he had his arm around her shoulder while they watched a comic telling dirty jokes nearby. I could have made a scene and asked him to switch back but I decided not to. I could take the embarrassment, but I didn't want to drag Robin into it. Plus I didn't know what I would do if he refused.

"That couple's in your seat sir," the usher said under his breath. "I'll ask them to move."

"Don't bother," I whispered back. I took the seat Scott had vacated.

"Enjoy the show," he said and walked away. That was when the second surprise happened. I thought I had made it back without being noticed. Again, I was wrong.

The comedian came over, and brought the spotlight with him. "Did everything come out alright?" he asked.

Ignoring him wasn't going to work. I decided to play along. I nodded my head.

"You go number 1?" He raised his index finger, waived it in the air.

Again I nodded. The audience laughed.

"Number 2?" he made a V, the audience snickered.

This time I shook my head.

"Oh.. How about a number 3-4-5?"

"Uh, I don't know what that is."

"I can't hear you," he said. He pointed his microphone in my face.

"I don't know what that is."

"Oh, then I'll teach you. Follow my lead."

I wasn't sure where this was going, but I was already into it so I played along. My stomach rumbled a little but I tried to ignore it. Maybe I should have stayed for a number 2.

The comedian pointed his index finger up again. I did the same. "That's 1." He added his middle finger. "That's 2." I did the same. Then in quick succession he extended his ring finger, his pinky and his thumb. I followed suit. "That's 3-4-5"

He then rolled his fingers into a fist and began to pretend to jack himself off. The audience laughed. I felt myself turn red. I was embarrassed but I

wasn't really mad. I think I had moved beyond that. I kinda enjoyed being part of the show. The jester was pretending to wank his wiener. He seemed to be having a good time. He looked at me expectantly.

I went in whole hog. I had put my hand down so I re-raised it. My first two fingers in a V. The comedian stopped his motioning and stood watching me, his arms folded across his chest. The audience quieted down. They wanted a show, so I was going to give them one. I slowly raised each other finger in turn, made a fist and began to simulate solo sex.

The audience erupted in laughter. There was even some applause. I started fast, then slowed down like I was really enjoying it. I closed my eyes and made my O-face. More laughter and applause. The crowd was loving it. I was loving it. I felt I was part of the show. But I was loving it too much and the man paid to make the people laugh knew it.

He deftly took back control.

"What a sport," he said into the mic. "What's your name sir?" he pointed the mic my way.

"Uh, Peter."

"Had to think there for a minute, didn't you?" A little laughter from the audience. "Thanks for sharing your interlude with us Peter." He put his arm around me and addressed the audience. "Everyone give Peter here a little love." Applause filled the hall for moment.

"So Peter, you here alone?"

I looked down at Robin. I didn't like where this was going. I could answer yes and probably get away easy. I wasn't in the mood for easy.

"No, I'm here with my wife."

The comedian look around. The only free seat was next to the lonely man. "Where is your wife, Peter?"

I pointed down at Robin. Scott quickly pulled his arm from around her shoulder, but he wasn't fast enough. Everyone saw. There was a little nervous laughter from around the auditorium. Here was my wife in the arms of another man. The scenario fit the show like a glove. There were probably some who thought it was staged. Hell, I would have if I wasn't in the middle of it.

The comedian was unfazed. He gave the audience a knowing look. "Well good luck with that, Peter." And with a toss of his head he moved on with the show, but not before getting off a few more jack off gestures.

I sat down. Robin patted me on the back. "That was great Peter. I didn't know you could be so funny."

I really wanted her to shut up. She meant well, but her words of encouragement weren't helping. All the alcohol was starting to hit, my stomach was tightening up and my wife was in the arms of another man. A little patronizing wasn't going to help.

I didn't really catch much of the end of the show. I looked on, but didn't see. I think it ended with an orgy. All the performers on stage pretending to have sex. Some with one or more partners. Some alone. Some watched. There were a lot of performers so they were able to show many positions, missionary, doggie, and oral. There were a few that I didn't recognize. Some I would like to try with Robin.

Overall I would say I loved the show and would like to see it again, but without an upset stomach and definitely without Scott.

Later, in the gift shop, Scott asked us if we wanted to do anything else. Maybe get a late bite to eat, or maybe do a little gambling. Robin looked at me expectantly. I think she was still willing to follow my lead. Maybe she

was impressed by my willingness to embarrass myself, or maybe she thought I deserved to make the decision because I put up with Scott.

Either way I never found out. I was about to say I wanted to call it a night when I doubled over in pain. Something seemed to explode in my stomach. I needed to throw up and I didn't want to do it all over the nice expensive Cirque merchandise.

I rushed to the bathroom. All the stalls seemed occupied so I vomited into a trash can. I realized I wasn't going to be able to have any more fun tonight, plus I needed to be up for a 9:00 lecture on Pet Training and Behavior Modification. I knew Robin would be pissed if I made her stay in the room with me. I saw she was having a good time and I really didn't want it to end for her. I wasn't going to be able to show her a good time, doubled over in pain; I might as well let Scott do it.

"I'm not going to be able to do anything else tonight," I said as I returned. "I'm not feeling too well, and I gotta get up early."

Robin got a serious look on her face. I think she was expecting me to force her to call it a night.

"But, Robin, if you want to go out with Scott, I don't mind. Just get me back to the room," and you two can paint the town red for all I care. I didn't say that last part.

I could have probably walked it, but we got a cab instead. Robin and I sat in back, my head in her lap, her fingers running through my hair. The cab let us off at our hotel entrance. Robin was going to escort me up to the room, while Scott got some Pepto at the drugstore nearby.

In the room Robin helped me get out of my clothes.

"You going to tell me that joke now?" I asked.

"You really want to hear it?"

"Yeah."

"It's kinda stupid and rude."

"I expect nothing less."

"Ok, but don't say I didn't warn you."

"I won't."

"What's the difference between jelly and jam?"

"Huh?"

"What's the difference between jelly and jam?"

"Uh, one has fruit particles in it?"

"That wouldn't be a very funny joke now would it."

"I don't know then, what is the difference between jelly and jam?"

Robin paused. It looked like she wanted to say it, but then she just broke out in laughter. "I can't say it."

"Robin! You can't leave me hanging like this."

"Come on, let's get you in bed, you don't want Scott to see you in your underwear."

"He saw you in less this afternoon at the pool."

She gave me a warning look. "Get in bed right now mister."

"Only if you get undressed and join me."

Again the look. "Not with Scott coming, and not with you getting ready to throw up."

I knew I wasn't going to win this one, and I didn't want to upset her. I just wish she wasn't able to have such a good time without me. I wanted to

share that feeling, but then my stomach did another flip and I ran to throw up in the toilet.

By the time I finished cleaning myself up, Scott had arrived. He took a bottle of Pepto out of the CVS bag and handed it to me. There was something else in the bag, but I didn't see what it was before he put it in his pocket.

"I see you didn't get dressed up for me," he said.

Now it was my turn to give dirty looks. Several mean comments came to mind. Robin interrupted before I could say anything stupid.

Scott stayed out in the sitting room while Robin tucked me into bed. She set the Pepto and a glass of water on the night stand.

"You be good," she said. She bent down to give me a kiss on the cheek. "You know I would kiss your mouth but..."

"Yeah, my breath probably smells like pig slop."

"Well it's not that bad, but it's no flower garden."

We shared a laugh. She did give me a kiss on the lips, but I kept them closed.

"Any idea when you'll get back?" It was 10:30.

"No, don't wait up."

Robin left to join Scott. He said goodbye and they both turned to leave.

"Wait," I called out. "What about the punch line?"

"I can't say it Peter." Robin said.

"Scott you tell me."

"No way, my friend."

"Robin!"

"Okay, you asked for it." Scott was already out of the room. Robin turned to look back at me before leaving. "I can't jelly my cock up your ass," She blew me a kiss as the door slammed shut behind her.

She really didn't want to say it, but Peter made her. At least that's what she convinced herself. It's just a stupid frat joke. One she finds incredibly funny.

My dear Peter, she thinks, you've been so understanding these last 24 hours and you deserve so much better.

She's sure she loves him. She feels a deep emotional bond with him. But tonight, she's caught a scent of adventure and she's following it to the end. That's why she's walking into the night, hand in hand, with a man who is not her husband.

Chapter 4

That *was* a rude joke. It made me giggle though. I imagined Scott telling it to Robin. Last week I would have said she'd smack anyone who said that to her, joke or not, but she had become a different woman. One I still loved, but who somehow changed and was drifting away.

Was I really going to lose her? She said she loved me and didn't want anything to come between us. Was that a lie? If so I was lost. I would fight any battle to save our marriage, as long as my wife was on my side and not against me.

I loved the straight-laced Robin with the long hair and moderately conservative clothes. I also found myself drawn to this new, more daring Robin. I just wish I could be spending more time with her. After this week I would be, I hoped.

I took a dose of Pepto and it immediately started soothing my stomachache. I shut my eyes and tried not to imagine Robin and Scott, out dancing, laughing, kissing. I hoped they weren't kissing. They almost did earlier this evening. They probably would have if I wasn't tagging along. Somehow I fell asleep.

I dreamt I was strolling down the Strip humming some silly tune I later realized was from the Zumanity show. It was just after dawn and the early morning sun glistened off the glass encased hotel towers. A cool breeze wafted up Las Vegas Boulevard. I was alone, save for a few songbirds flittering about.

Without warning thousands of couples began pouring out of every door. They came from the casinos. They came from the hotels. They came from restaurants, bars and shops. They even came from the kiosks that sold discount show tickets. They came from everywhere and swarmed past me. And each couple, a man and a woman, and the woman was Robin and the man was Scott. I woke up in a sweat.

I don't know how long I lay there, in the dark. A few seconds, a few minutes, maybe an hour? I was lying there with my eyes wide open,

watching the neon lights dance around the edges of the window curtains. Again that void drew my attention. It was larger this time because I was closer to it.

I heard the hall door open, spilling more light into the room. Neither entered the room right away.

"Peter," Robin whispered. "Peter, are you awake?"

I just lay there, eyes closed, saying nothing. I wanted to see what would happen. I wanted to maybe witness what Robin and Scott did when I wasn't around. I reminded myself to breathe. It took a lot of effort to remain calm.

"He seems asleep to me," Robin said.

"Can I come in?" Scott asked.

"No, you better not. I think it's time to call it a night."

"I had a great time this evening, a really great time," Scott said emphasizing the word 'great'.

"So did I," Robin said softly. "Thank you for everything. I really enjoyed myself."

Then silence. I opened my eyes for a peek. The hall lights cast their shadow into the room. A single shadow. They were hugging and then I realized it wasn't silent at all. I heard the wet sounds of two pairs of lips smacking, tongues yearning to explore new places. I felt my stomach begin to erupt again, but I was determined not to move. If I threw up, I would have still lie there and drown in my own vomit.

There were so many fucking emotions exploding in my mind. Anger, sadness and jealousy chief among them. But also curiosity, surprise and even arousal fought for room to breathe. For some fucking reason I found it hot to think of my wife kissing someone else. I always got aroused when she kissed me passionately. I guess my body was reacting to those

memories. Maybe helping me cope with the other, more hostile emotions. I hoped the rising tent pole under the sheets didn't give me away.

Somehow I remained in bed and didn't jump up and clobber Scott. I couldn't blame just him. Robin was totally into the kiss and she deserved some blame, too. I was disappointed, but for some reason glad that she was enjoying herself.

I was truly and royally fucked up.

The couple at the door, it was still hard to call them Robin and Scott, finally broke their embrace.

"Good night," she whispered.

"Good night," Scott replied.

The hall door closed and darkness returned, but only briefly. Almost immediately after she shut the door, Robin turned on the sitting room light. I moved a little, faking I had just woken up. I reached for the water glass next to me. It almost slipped out due to the heavy condensation on the side.

I looked at the clock. It read 3:12.

"Did you have a good time?" I asked as gently as I could. I wanted to sound like I was really curious, but I settled for not sounding sarcastic.

"You're awake," she said, casually, with just a hint of surprise. Like I caught her off guard. "Yes, we did have a good time."

She undressed in the dim light.

"What did you do?"

Robin sighed. "Nothing much. We stayed close, went to the Aria. You and I need to go there. It's amazing." She paused as if trying to find something to say.

"First we went to a little English pub. I was starving since I only had half a salad for dinner. Food was good, but man was it overpriced."

She slipped into bed totally naked. We both lay on our sides, facing each other.

"I had the fish and chips, Scott had this huge hot dog. Very messy."

"What did you do after that?"

"We went to a club, I don't remember the name. Had a few more drinks and danced for a while. After that Scott played a little Blackjack. I watched."

"That's it?"

Another pause before she answered. "Yes, that's it."

I reached out and began stroking her body. I started at her head, running my fingers gently through her short hair. I really missed her long tresses. I ran my hand down her cheek, over her shoulder and down the side of her abdomen. I could feel the goose bumps forming on her soft skin, a sure sign of arousal.

"How are you feeling?" she asked.

"Much better."

I ran my palm across her back and down to cup her butt. I pulled her towards me.

"Ouch," I said. My erection got caught between us and it hurt.

"Someone's awake," my wife said. I could hear the amusement in her voice.

I really needed to make love to her. I needed her to make love to me. My suspicions needed soothing and my anxiety needed calming. Making love would turn this horrible night around. I brought my hand around front

and began to gently knead her breast. I was about to pinch her nipples when she reached up to stop me.

"Not tonight dear," she whispered. "I'm tired and you need to get up early."

"I'm willing to suffer," I said.

"Let's just cuddle."

Now it was my turn to sigh. A harsh and abrupt breath of air passed my lips. Let's cuddle. The dread phrase no horny man ever wants to hear. My cock didn't hear it and remained hard. My wife turned her back to me and we spooned, my penis nestled between her ass cheeks. I had to hold very still or I was going to make a mess.

Despite the sexual rejection, it felt good. I would never grow tired of holding my wife. Even if I wanted more, I would settle for anything she offered.

She fell asleep in my arms, but I took a moment longer just to enjoy the sensations. Her warm body pressed close to mine, the faint aroma of hibiscus, like an expensive body wash. We were as one, Robin and I. It was only us. No Veterinary Conference to go to tomorrow, and no Scott.

Just one thing was bothering me, but I couldn't put my finger on it. Maybe it would come to me in the morning. I wanted to dream of Robin and I making love, instead I went out cold.

My eyes opened with a start. I turned to look at the clock. It read 8:15. Fuck, I forgot to set the alarm. I was going to be late.

I hurried into the bathroom to take a quick shower and brush my teeth. No time to shave today. They'll be lucky I don't stink like a sewer. I came out and started to quickly get dressed. Today was going to be even more casual, a pair of black jeans and a white button down shirt. No tie.

I looked over at the clock again, 8:43. Maybe I could grab a coffee and danish at Starbucks and only be a few minutes late. I was slipping on my shoes when I looked over at Robin, still asleep lying on her back. The white bed sheet covered most of her lower torso save for a small tuft of pubic hair that teased me.

She looked so lovely, a slight smile played across the serene calm of her face. If she was dreaming, it must be pleasant; I trusted I was in it. I was in no mood to think otherwise. She could also have just been pretending to sleep and instead enjoying watching me frantically getting ready for the day. I was in too much of a rush to find out.

I bent over and gave her a kiss on the cheek. As I did, I saw a small but noticeable bruise on her left breast. I knew she didn't have it at the pool yesterday; her bathing suit didn't cover that much. Did I do that last night when I was pawing at her, fruitlessly trying to seduce her?

It was ten til 9 and I didn't have time to obsess over it. I grabbed my phone and wallet, making sure I had my room key. My wife still asleep as the door closed behind me.

At 9:45 I was again sitting in the back of a crowded conference room. A stale half-eaten pastry sat on a plate next to a lukewarm cup of coffee in front of me. It was conference coffee, not Starbucks.

This morning's presentation was all about proper pet training. The speaker showed how vets could increase their income by offering training and behavior modification services. This was mostly a sales pitch for a six week training course we could send our employees to, but it also focused on how we could fold the services into our current fee system.

I look around for Dr. Cho. This seemed to be the kind of workshop she would take. I didn't see any other courses on today's agenda that would

appeal to an animal shelter vet.

The speaker was passing out a list of textbooks available for the course when I felt a buzz in my pocket. It was a text from Robin.

-We're doing lunch right?

I didn't think we had discussed it. Maybe subconsciously I assumed she was spending all morning with the spa owner, and I just didn't want to think about that. I couldn't even say his fucking name.

-If you want.

-YES, I want. U better be here if U know what's good for U.

An ultimatum. That was new. And she seemed eager to see me, not like yesterday. Then a scary thought ran through my jealous mind. What if she thought she was texting Scott. That could happen, I've seen it on T.V.

-You do know this is your husband, not your boyfriend ;)

I was being silly serious. Like it was a joke, but not.

-Peter Wilkenson, you shit.

No humorous emoticons.

-Sorry.

-I forgive you. Just be here. Gotta go. Luv ya.

-Luv ya 2

By 11:45 I'd had enough. I packed up my notes and handouts, and took advantage of sitting in the back of the room to sneak out. Would have made a clean getaway, but out in the hall I ran into Alex from the Glossman Pharmaceuticals.

"I can't get away from you, can I?" he said as I almost bowled right into him.

"Guess not," I said.

"Leaving early?"

"Yeah, gotta hot lunch date with my wife."

"You sure? My company is sponsoring the meal. Sirloin steak sandwiches."

I looked at my phone, it was ten til. If I was late, I was sure she would just leave and run right into Scott's arms. I was at a low point, so that kind of crap would of course leap into my mind.

"I haven't spent much time with her the last couple of days, so I need to take every second I can get."

Alex seemed amused with my situation. "Maybe you should have left her at home."

That was a great idea. I wish I had thought of that sooner.

"I couldn't, tomorrow's our anniversary."

"Oh, a work and pleasure thing."

"Yeah. Hey, don't mean to be rude, but I have to run."

"No problem, Peter isn't it?"

"Yeah."

We shook hands.

"I saw your name on the sign-up list for the Pain Management panel. I'll see you then."

"Cool," I said as I ran off down the hall. It was 11:55.

The elevator took forever to arrive. When the doors opened, the car was full.

"Sorry, no room," someone in the back called out.

This car was going up and I wasn't waiting for another. "There's always room for one more," I said as I forced my way in. Several people grumbled, but in the end we all made it safely to our separate floors.

I pulled out my key card as I rushed down the hall. My phone had said 12:00, so technically I could still be on time. I really didn't think my wife would leave if I was a minute or two late. Actually, she probably wouldn't have left no matter how long I took. I was just really anxious for some quality time with Robin.

The green light couldn't come on fast enough for me after I slid my card in. I opened the door.

"I made it," I shouted triumphantly.

The sitting room was empty. I was expecting Robin to be sitting at the table with lunch spread out. I only had an hour.

"I'm in here," she called from the bedroom. I hadn't noticed the door was closed. Relief flooded through my body, washing away all the tension that had built up the last couple of days.

I opened the bedroom door and a different tension took hold and it was painful.

There on the bed was my wife, naked as I had left her. She was spread eagle on her back, her upper body exposed, her lower parts covered by the sheet. The bed cover had been thrown off, so the only things on the bed were a few pillows, a thin white sheet, and my wife.

Blood rushed to my cock, which unfortunately had been lying in an awkward position. I had to adjust myself.

"I'd help you with that but," my wife said. "as you can see, I'm indisposed."

She was indisposed because there was food covering some parts of her body. Celery and carrot sticks ran up her tight flat abdomen. An assortment of cheeses were spread out across her upper chest. On her breasts two red pepper rings sat circling her nipples. She had poured ranch dressing in one hand, the other was free.

"You hungry?" she asked.

"I could eat you up, but there's all this food in the way."

She laughed. "I thought I'd do something special for you today, since you mostly behaved yourself yesterday."

"I hope you saved something for tomorrow."

"That depends on how today goes."

I wasn't sure what to make of that, but my wife was lying naked and offering herself to me, so I wasn't going to complain.

"So where to start?" I picked up a celery stick from Robin's stomach. She held out her hand. I scooped up some dressing and took a bite. The celery and dressing were a little warm, but no salad had ever tasted better. I took a carrot stick dipped in dressing and then inserted it into Robin's navel. She giggled a bit. I took a bite of the carrot, then offered her the rest.

I then bent over her and licked dressing out of her bellybutton. "That tickles," she said as she started to shake with laughter. All the carrots and most the celery rolled onto the floor. I started laughing myself. "I was going to have some sushi brought up so you could eat that off my body," she said, "but I wasn't sure your tummy could handle it."

"This is perfect," I said.

I took the one piece of celery that didn't fall on the floor and dipped again. I traced a line of ranch dressing down her body, starting at a spot just

between her two pepper ringed nipples down her stomach. I made two circles around her navel then moved towards the promised land that lay just under the thin bed sheet. She grabbed my arm with her free hand before I could reach my goal.

"No, you have to finish your veggies before you can have desert." She pointed to the cheese, and red peppers.

I wiped the cheese slices onto the floor where they joined the carrots and celery. "I've got a lactose problem," I said with a smile. My wife opened her mouth to speak, but I put a finger to her lips before she could. "Hush." I then bent down and nibbled one of the peppers. I started with the right breast. I was halfway round when I took a gentle nip at her nipple. A soft sigh escaped her lips.

"Very nice peppers," I said. I finished the one I started with and moved on to her left breast. My eyes briefly passed by the bruise I had seen earlier, but I was too lost in my passion to really notice it. Even after the last of the pepper was gone, I continued to use my mouth on her breasts, licking and nipping around her quarter-sized aureolas and sucking her nipples until they were hard. I glanced up at my wife's face. Her eyes were closed, her lips slightly parted. I tried to move away, but she held my head tight to her bosom with her free hand. She was enjoying my oral ministrations too much.

She did finally allow me to move my head. I pulled her messy palm to my lips to lick away the remaining dressing. I took her head in my hands and fiercely kissed her. My tongue explored her mouth, sharing the tangy taste of the dressing.

"May I have my dessert now?" I whispered into her ear.

"Oh my, of course you can."

She wiped her greasy palm on a hand towel she had strategically placed on the nightstand. In one grand motion she pulled the sheet away from the lower portion of her body. "Tah Dah!"

I just stared in shock and awe. Her pussy, normal hidden by a tuft of neatly trimmed hair, was totally bare.

"Holy fuck," was all I could say. "Now you really do look like a twenty-one year old co-ed. How'd I ever get so lucky?"

"You married me, of course."

"You do that for me?" I said, indicating her smooth mound.

"Yes." I noticed a slight hesitation in her voice.

"Really?"

"Ok, I did it for me and for you." Nice save. "I've wanted to see how it feels, so I thought I'd give it a try. Hell, if I don't like it, I can grow my thatch back.

"I liked your thatched snatch."

"Very funny, now eat your dessert."

"I thought you'd never ask." I lost no time diving for the treasure that lay between her legs. That's when I noticed a single maraschino cherry tucked between her lips. It was coated with simple syrup and Robin's own juices. I decided to take my time and not dive straight for the prize. I began nibbling around the edges of her opening. I then traced the outer folds with my tongue. Robin's sighs turned to moans. "Oh Peter, that feels so nice." I loved to hear her say that. "But you better not leave me hanging."

"Nehmer," I said. I meant to say never, but my tongue was otherwise engaged.

I plunged my tongue deep between the folds of Robin's labia. I went deeper than the cherry, thrusting in and out, with a steady rhythm. I felt the walls of my wife's pussy contracting, trying to pull the cherry and my tongue further in. The pressure was rising and her juices continued to flow.

"Oh God baby, don't stop, I'm so close"

When Robin is cumming, I know I can extend her orgasm by sucking on her clitoris like I'm giving her a little blow job. I wanted to try something different this time. I puckered up my lips as tight as I could and sucked the cherry out of her vagina. Then I placed it between my tongue and her clit and then just rolled it around.

"Oh.. OH. OHHHHH!" Robin had arrived. I continued the motion until her "OHHHHH's" went back to "oh's"

"I popped your cherry," I said, chewing on the tangy sweet treat. I was so proud of myself.

"You're a little late for that, I was 28 when we met."

"Always so literal. At least that hasn't changed."

"Isn't that why you love me?"

"I guess. We'll, that was some dessert."

"I think I enjoyed it more," she said. "Let me return the favor."

She pushed me down on the bed and proceeded to loosen my belt and pull down my zipper. I lifted my hips to allow her to take my jeans off. For a moment I wondered what time it was, but then Robin took my cock into her mouth and time became meaningless to me. My wife doesn't do oral sex on me too often. She knows I enjoy it, but, since she gets nothing out of it, she sees it more as a chore. When she does decide I deserve a blow job, I know I've been very good.

Robin wasted no time working her tongue all the way around my shaft. Once it was well lubricated she popped the head between her lips and began bobbing up and down. She was able to take about a half of my length, she worked the remainder with her hands.

It didn't take long for my climax to come.

"I'm going to cum soon Robin." I needed to warn her because she doesn't swallow. She just kept on pumping and sucking. "Robin..."

ROBIN..." I could not hold back any longer. "I'm CUMMING." For the first time in our relationship, I filled my mouth's wife with my seed and she swallowed it all. She continued sucking until my dick deflated.

"I'm sorry," I said. "I tried to warn you."

"I heard you. I wanted to try something new. It's not as bad as I thought."

"Will you do it again?"

"Maybe."

"Oh, crap, I've only got fifteen minutes to get back to the conference. And I really need to be at this one."

I pulled my jeans up and went to wash my hands. Robin turned on the shower so she could clean herself up from our carnal lunch.

"You have any plans for this afternoon?" I asked.

"Not really. When will you be done today?" she asked as she got into the shower. I watched the water cascade down her body, washing away the evidence of our debauchery.

"Last session ends at 4:15."

"How about we meet at BurGR around 4:30 for a real meal."

"Will do, gotta run."

Robin peeked out of the shower. "You forgetting something?"

"No," I said, giving her a kiss.

"Good. Bye now."

"Bye."

I grabbed my wallet and phone and left.

I was halfway down the hall when I realized I had the wrong phone. I looked down and saw Robin had a text message and it wasn't from me. It was from Scott. She had added him as a contact and his name popped up on the screen.

It arrived a few minutes ago, while we were in the bathroom.

- Be at your place at 1:30.

But she told me she didn't have any plans. I unlocked the phone and read the string of messages. It started at around 10 that morning.

Scott - Hey, wonderful time last night. Up for even more this morning?

Robin - Too tired. Got plans with the hubby.

Scott - Can't you blow him off?

Robin - I'm planning on it :)

Scott - Lucky man

Robin - So are you ;)

Scott - Yeah I am. Text me when you want me to come by.

Robin - 1:30. 2:00 at the latest. Gotta be done by 4.

What The Fuck was that? I thought. She told Scott she was going to give me a blow job? And if I read the rest right she had already given him one. What. The. Fuck. And then planning another hookup behind my back.

I went back to the room to confront her. I opened the door and heard her in the shower humming away. I was so mad I just wanted to smash something, but then I realized what she was humming. It was the song from our first dance together at our wedding.

"It's just me," I called out. "I forgot my phone." I didn't tell her I had picked up hers by mistake.

"Ok. See ya later." If she was worried about me running into Scott, she didn't let on.

I looked at the clock. I was already late. Had to hurry. I put her phone back where I found it and grabbed mine. I knew I was going to be a wreck all afternoon wondering what was going on. Were they just planning on talking? I knew they had kissed, maybe that was what they would do, some light kissing. I strongly suspected she had given him a blow job. That was crossing some kind of line, wasn't it? I should ask her about it. If I stay here, I'll run into him. Then we'd have to confront the situation.

But what if I'm wrong? What if it's all a simple misunderstanding? Then I look like a fool and Robin will be embarrassed. She'll get mad at me and I'll be sleeping on the couch until our next anniversary.

What the fuck am I supposed to do?

Then my eyes fell upon the door to the room next to ours, the one held by Glossman Pharma. And a plan formed in my head. A devious plan that would allow me to find out just what the hell was going on between my wife and her new friend.

I quietly unlocked our side of the partition door before heading downstairs. I was only twenty minutes late getting back to the conference.

The warm spray of water washes away the remnants of their tryst. If only it could wash away the guilt and the doubt as easily.

Peter is her love, her friend, her closest companion, but Scott...

Oh, Scott is something different. Scott is dangerous.

And last night. Oh, last night. The memories fill her with desire. Last night was a new, and delicious experience.

She knew it was wrong. She would have to be careful.

Chapter 5

"You have to be very careful with the doses," one drug company rep said. "Age and weight have to be taken into consideration."

"And always have a colleague double-check the charts," another added.

"These new meds are very effective, but nothing will kill a practice faster than killing your patients."

The chatter going on in the front of the room was important, but I heard very little of it. My mind was elsewhere. My eyes scanned the words on the handouts, but their meaning stayed on the page. Nothing filtered into my head. I was too busy processing the latest bit of shit that got dumped on my anniversary trip.

Robin told me she had no plans, yet she was meeting Scott at our room. Didn't that at least deserve a mention? Maybe she didn't think it mattered, but I did. She knew it mattered to me, even if she was cool with it. Just a hint, just a word. Like, 'hey Peter, Scott's dropping by and we're going out to the pool.' Or a 'hey, Peter, Scott and I are going to do some more shopping, anything you want me to get you?'

I wasn't going to begrudge her some fun. I had no problem with her seeing Scott, but I really preferred she was upfront about it. The way she was hiding the rendezvous made me think something else was going on, something I would not be happy with. Like last night's passionate goodnight kiss. A quick peck on the cheek or lips is fine between friends. A deep soul kiss isn't.

Did I think they were upstairs making out while I was here supposedly learning new techniques to relieve feline pain? I'm not totally naïve; yes, I did think there was a very good chance that was what they were doing.

Did I think they were fucking? Oh, God, I didn't even want to contemplate that.

Robin told me she wouldn't do anything that might hurt our relationship. I trusted her, but I also thought that Scott's cock was something that might come between us.

Whatever was happening, I wasn't going to make any rash decisions. I wanted to wait until I knew for sure what was going on. Then, and only then, would I act. I had acted before learning the facts many years earlier, and I wasn't going to do that again.

I was a senior in college trying to finish up my pre-med degree at Arizona. I was dating a girl named Lisa. She was gorgeous, a tall well-built blond with an IQ that put mine to shame. We stayed up nights debating various philosophies before making love. The winner of the argument got to be on top. I was on the bottom more times than not.

One day, near the end of the semester, I briefly glanced at a note Lisa had written on a pad by her phone. It said she had a reservation at a fancy hotel in downtown Tucson. She hadn't mentioned anything to me about it. I let it slide, not wanting her to think I was nosey.

The night of the reservation approached and still no mention from Lisa. I was getting concerned. It was set for the night of my graduation. I expected she was going to watch me graduate and then we would go out and celebrate. When I asked her, she said she couldn't make it to the ceremony. I was disappointed, but not heartbroken over it. But then I found out my best friend Duane wasn't going to make it either. I pushed him for details and he said he had an emergency commitment. Somehow that same hotel came up in the conversation.

Well, I wasn't graduating with honors for nothing. I put two and two together and figured they were having an affair. It didn't dawn on me that if they were having an affair, they would have been a little more subtle. I was book smart, but not too people smart.

I confronted Lisa and, instead of listening to her side of the story, I called her a slut and accused her of sleeping with my best friend. After lots of screaming and crying, she told me the hotel reservation was for a

surprise graduation party. About 15 of my closest friends and family were invited. I felt like a dick.

The party went ahead and most of the attendees had a good time. Lisa and I split up two weeks later.

Since that time I had become overly cautious when it came to dealing with people and their motivations. I never wanted to fuck up so badly again. Did I get taken a few times? Yeah. But I find you get a whole lot further in the world if you're willing to trust. I had a wonderful wife and a meaningful and successful career. I didn't do too badly.

The panel took a pause for a quick 15-minute break. Everyone ran off to grab a smoke, take a piss, or maybe get a cup of coffee. I needed to do something else. I looked at my phone. It was 2:45.

I went up to my new friend Alex Spenser who was taking part in the seminar. "Alex, some of your new products look very promising." First the small talk.

"We think so," he said. "By the way, I'm about halfway done with that action plan you wanted. I think we'll have no problems meeting your needs and staying within budget."

"Good. We're looking for a reliable source for our drugs and demand will only grow with the expansion."

"I'll e-mail you the final schedule when I'm done," Alex said. "Probably next Wednesday, Thursday at the latest."

"Great," I said. Now my real reason for approaching Alex. "Hey, just on the off chance, do you still have access to the room next to mine?"

"Um, yeah. I was planning on turning the key in when I checked out on Friday. Why?"

"I've got a friend driving in from Flagstaff tonight and..."

Alex cut me off. "Wait, don't tell me. You want me to let him crash in the room?"

"Yeah."

"That's an odd request."

"I know, I wouldn't ask, but we're taking our wives to see the Britney show tonight and maybe do a little late night gambling. A room nearby would be a godsend."

I don't know where I learned to lie so well. Maybe it was from lying to all the kids. Telling little Billy or Ava that Snowflake was going off to an animal farm. They had special break-out sessions at these conferences where people shared their own methods for soothing children's fears.

I just hoped Alex didn't know I had a sofa bed in my room to offer my imaginary friends. He was staying in one of the fancy multi-bedroom suites upstairs, so I doubt he was aware of what we lowly schlubs had to deal with.

Alex was thinking about it. I couldn't read his face to know which way he was leaning. I really needed that room. Maybe a little push.

"I'll pay you for it," I offered.

"Oh no, that could get me in trouble."

Fuck, I hope I didn't ruin my chances.

"Tell you what. Since we're going to do some big business between us, I'll let you have the room and I'll just write it off our Customer Incentive Account. We give these kinds of perks and bonuses to our clients all the time."

He pulled out the key card and offered it to me. I reached out to take it, but he didn't immediately let go.

"Make sure the room isn't trashed," he said. "And no raiding the in-room snack bar."

"I promise."

"Any room charges will be doubled and added to our contract."

"Deal."

He let go of the key card and I headed toward my seat.

I never did return to my seat. Instead I grabbed my notes and handouts and headed out. There was no way I was going to be able to sit still, thinking about Robin.

I wanted to trust my wife, I always had before, but there were too many reasons not to right now. I needed to clear things up before I could move on.

The elevator took forever to reach the 19th floor. The walk down the hall took longer. I wanted to run, but I kept my cool. "No rash decisions," I told myself.

At the door to our room, I took out my key card and slowly but firmly inserted it into the slot. The yellow privacy light came on and the door remained locked. I tried again, just to be sure and again the yellow light appeared, taunting me, denying me access to my wife.

It looked like my worst fears were being realized. My wife had turned the deadbolt on me. Making sure I couldn't disturb whatever was going on inside.

I could have knocked, but that would have given up the game. They could stall, lie, make up any story about why they were in the room together

with me locked out. Robin could tell me any fanciful story and I would believe her. She just had that way with me. I had to find out for sure; I had to see it for myself. The only things that I would believe over my wife were my own eyes. And even then, she could still probably bluff me.

I took out the other key I had, and moved on to the next door. I slid it in and was immediately greeted by the green light. I looked down at the light. It said to me, you're good to go. You're good to have your entire life ripped away and shattered. Enter this room if you dare, leave all hope behind. Dante's Inferno was never this daunting.

I screwed up my courage and entered. This room was smaller than mine. It held a single queen-sized bed, one small table with one chair against the far wall below the window. A dresser with a flat screen TV on it sat opposite the bed. The bathroom was on the left. Across the room, standing like the gate to hell, was the access door to mine and Robin's room.

As carefully as I could, I undid the dead bolt on this side. If Robin had noticed the door was un-locked and re-bolted it, I was screwed. I would have to go to plan C. There was only one way to find out. I grabbed the handle and was about to turn it when I stopped.

This was it, the point of no return. If I opened this door, my life would be changed forever, no take backs, no refunds. But then, my life was already changed. If I didn't go in, I'd never know the truth and I'd never totally trust Robin again. At least by going in I'd find the answers I needed. I wanted to believe my wife again. I couldn't live otherwise. So I opened the door and went in.

The moment I crossed the threshold, I knew I was undone. I heard them before I saw them. An unmistakable sound. Deep, passionate moans, both masculine and feminine. In a desperate grasp to maintain my sanity, I hoped my wife was just sitting in the bedroom alone watching a pay-per-view X-rated film. Yes, she was probably sitting alone, maybe naked, no, definitely naked. Lying back against the headboard, hands between her legs, her fingers manipulating her newly-shorn pussy.

At that moment, that was what I truly believed. The fact that we had never watched an adult movie together never crossed my mind. I decided then and there to never doubt Robin again.

I slowly made my way further into the room, until I was just able to see into the bedroom. Robin had left that door open. I guess she figured the dead bolt was enough to keep me, or housekeeping, away.

The scene that came into view left me stunned and unable to move.

Robin, my wife of almost 3 years, was on the bed, naked, but not alone. She was laid out flat on her back. Scott was on top of her, slowly thrusting his hips, up and down between her thighs. I couldn't see actual penetration, but even I had to admit, they were fucking.

Robin's legs were hooked around Scott's thighs, her hands grasping his buttocks, pulling him further into her with each thrust. Her head was thrown back. Her eyes were closed. Her moans escaping her slightly parted lips, each utterance an icy stab in the heart. I had heard those moans many times before, but up close in my ears, never from far away. I had never even watched her masturbate. Any pleasure she revealed, was due to me and my actions.

All my focus was on Robin, but I couldn't help but see Scott, since he was firmly planted between us. The first thing I noticed about him, other than his overall fitness, was an intriguing full color tattoo. A Siberian tiger covered about half the left side of his back. It looked as if the cat was riding Scott, while he was riding my wife. Its eye's looking back at me. The tiger saying, she's ours now.

A quick, rough grunt punctuated each thrust of Scott's tight round ass.

One very dim ray of light fell on this inky black tableau. A silver foil condom wrapper sat on the nightstand table next to the bed, my side of the bed. At least they were using protection. I had no doubt it was a box of condoms Scott had stuffed into his pocket last night.

It felt like I stood there forever, although I knew it was only a moment, counted in seconds, not hours.

I was frozen, unable to move. My brain giving so many contradictory commands that my body just gave up. One command, rush into the room, tear Scott away and reclaim Robin, the primal alpha response. Another command, flee from the room, forget you're married, maybe join a monastery, typical beta male response.

Then there was a unique command. Stand and watch. Enjoy the show. Forget who's taking part. I was embarrassed to realize I had grown rock hard watching my wife get fucked. I had to admit she was a very attractive woman and she exuded an exotic air of sensuality while a strong handsome man pounded her pussy with his cock. It was like the best porno I had ever seen, very high production values. Without thinking, I pointed my phone at the rutting couple and took a picture capturing the painfully erotic moment in digital high def perfection.

I looked at the results and I couldn't help admiring the quality of the shot. I could see the sweat beading up on Scott's back. The pleasure that played across my wife's face was thoroughly visible. I could really masturbate to this picture.

My focus returned to the action when my wife's moaning became more urgent. "Oh fuck me Scott," she said. The words burned my ears. In the past during some of our own lovemaking, she had called out my name in passion, but not with such urgency. "Don't. Stop. Just. Fuck. Me." With each word she pushed her hips up to meet her lover's downward strokes. Scott had to increase his speed to match my wife's. It didn't look like he was planning to stop until he filled the condom.

"Oh Scott. I'm cumminggggg" and I knew from experience, the guttural sounds she was making proved she was. It was a long climax and before her cries of pleasure could ebb, I watched as Scott's ass clenched and he gave a series of triumphal cries, signaling his own orgasm.

Now I really had to decide what to do. The couple on the bed had been so focused on their own pleasure that I had escaped detection. However

high their passion had taken them, they were coming down and would soon spot me. I had to make a choice, one that would determine all our futures.

They both had made their own choices, ones that led to this moment. Now it was my turn. I could stay and confront them, or leave. If I confronted them now, my marriage would probably be over. I saw no way to save it. My marriage was still probably doomed even if I left, calmed down and thought everything through so we could discuss the situation like rational adults.

I chose to leave the lovers in their afterglow. If I had to deal with my wife's infidelity, I'd rather Scott wasn't around. It was going to be a long road back to what Robin and I had. We may never even get there. All I knew is that the first step on that journey was out the way I came.

The lovers were kissing when I left them. An intimate moment that hurt me more than their rutting had done.

As I made my way downstairs, I couldn't help but laugh at my situation. This afternoon Robin had been my dessert, but I was just her appetizer.

Post-coital bliss. No other thoughts enter the mind, just the memory of the pleasure.

A kiss roots her in the moment. She returns it with passion.

Scott felt good inside her. His technique is different than her husband's. They both make her feel good, but in totally different ways, totally different flavors.

Peter is chocolate, Scott, cayenne pepper.

She runs her hands down her lover's smooth chest, fingers playing along his well-defined muscles towards his softening cock.

She wants another go. A little more spice, before her chocolatey dessert later that night.

A wicked smile alights in her hazel eyes.

Chapter 6

I had no intention of returning to the conference. The thought didn't even cross my mind. I had no intention of going home either. In fact, I didn't really know where I was going.

I got out of the elevator and headed across the casino floor. A cacophony of slot machines, pop tunes and the screams of lucky players filled the air around me, but I didn't hear a thing. I was stuck in my own tragic world. The scene from upstairs played in my head like a never ending porno loop. But there would be no happy endings for me in this one.

I walked out into the hot Vegas sun and started down the street. Was I heading north or south? I didn't really know, didn't really care. I passed the Paris resort, so I thought I was heading downtown. Balley's was next, then up and over Flamingo road. I just kept walking, measuring time by footsteps with no destination in mind.

I was approaching the Venetian when the full force of what happened hit me. I doubled over in pain. Tears began flowing from my eyes. I'm sure I was getting plenty of funny looks from the tourists, but spend any time in Las Vegas and you'll see plenty of stranger things than a grown man rolled up in a ball on the sidewalk, crying.

While I was in this state of hysteria, I lost track of time. It could have been 15 minutes, twenty, maybe half an hour. All I knew was that after a while, I just ran out of tears. I had none left to shed. Maybe if I drank some water and thought about it more I would be able to start crying again. For now, I was done.

I stood up and reassessed the situation. What was I going to do next? Here I was, standing in the middle of America's gambling mecca. Possibility ruled. Take a chance, win a million bucks, or lose your life, or your wife. For the first time since I started seriously dating Robin, I felt totally and utterly alone.

The sun was beginning to work its way behind the grand hotel towers that lined the strip. I didn't know what time it was and I really didn't care at

the moment. I gave no thought to the future. For me, there was only the present.

I had worked the worst of the depression out of my system. I knew there was more pain inside me, but at least for now it kept low and out of sight. No doubt it would return when Robin and I battled over the house, our awesome vinyl LP collection and who got to keep the few mutual friends we had accumulated in the six years of our relationship. I think John and Stacy would stay with Robin. I'd get George.

Determined to end my public display of depression, I picked my sorry ass up off the ground and moved on. The twin brown towers of the Wynn and Encore resorts loomed ahead of me. I'd never gambled there before. The table minimums were usually too large for my budget-sized bank roll. Today was different. I had \$400 burning a hole in my pocket, half of it Robin's. She had our winnings from two nights ago in the safe, so I didn't think she'd care about me blowing what I had. Who was I kidding? I doubted she was even thinking about me, about us, at the moment. I could splurge for a little while and work out the details of our separation later.

I finally looked at my phone; it was only ten to 4.

I entered the casino. The cool air-conditioned air enveloped me in a chilly cocoon. I had to walk past rows of designer boutiques selling only the finest fashion and accessories. I passed one window and saw a purse Robin would have loved. For just a brief moment I thought about getting it for her, but then I remembered that was Scott's privilege now.

My eyes began to well up again. I covered my face with my hands and fought hard to hold back the tears. A public breakdown in here would bring casino security, and that would not end well. I forced myself to stand up straight.

I found a men's room and splashed cold water on my face. It felt good cleaning away the salt that had accumulated from my tears and sweat. I dried my face with a paper towel. I took a moment to compose myself and continued on into the casino. This time ignoring all the shops I passed.

The gaming floor at the Wynn was more subdued than at Planet Hollywood. It was still lined with restaurants and bars, but they were more upscale and unique. Instead of a P.F. Chang's, there was the Red 8.

The casino might have been busy on the weekends, but at 4 o'clock on this day, it was dead. I looked around trying to decide what I wanted to play. I was in no mood for anything too taxing. I wasn't sure I could focus well enough to play craps. I knew baccarat was simple, but it always intimidated me, so that was a no-go. I was sure as hell not going to play roulette. I could have played slots, mindlessly pulling the handle, but that seemed too simple and I doubted it would take my mind off my problems.

I finally sat down at a \$25 blackjack table. I knew the rules and the basic strategy, so it would be easy to put myself on autopilot and just play. I put five 20's and three 100 dollar bills on the table. The dealer, a tall older white man with grey hair counted the money and laid the bills out on the table in front of him.

"Greens, sir?" he asked.

"Yeah."

He grabbed a stack of green chips from the tray in front of him and made four even stacks of four chips.

"Four hundred going out." he called out. A short, balding white man in an ill-fitting tan suit turned his head to look over. He had been watching a couple of blousy brunettes trying to learn to play 3-card poker. "Go ahead," he said, waving his hand our way.

The dealer gathered the 16 chips into one stack and slid it across the table to me.

"Good Luck, sir," he said.

"It can only get better from here," I replied. I put a single green chip in the betting circle in front of me and the dealer started dealing.

I had an ace and an eight. Dealer was showing a five.

I was the only player at the table so it didn't matter how long I took to make my decisions. I was in no hurry. I had no where to go, no one to answer to. It was still just hitting me that I was single again. Not legally, but emotionally.

I waved my hand over the cards, the signal to stay.

The dealer flipped over a nine. The house had 14, and had to take another card. The dealer dealt a jack for a total of 24.

"Bust," the dealer said.

I was up 25 dollars. Maybe this would be the beginning of something big for me. I ordered beer from a passing cocktail waitress.

My fortune went back and forth. At one time I was up a hundred, but the cards turned against me and I was soon down the same. I was about to place a \$50 bet when I felt a buzz in my pocket. It was probably my wife. I ignored it. Several bets later it buzzed again. I pulled out my phone to see what she wanted.

"Sorry sir," the dealer said. "No phones at the table."

I excused myself and stepped away.

As expected it was Robin.

-where R U?

I didn't know how to answer that. I could say where I was, but I didn't really want to see Robin just yet. I wasn't ready. I still hadn't processed the day's activities, plus I needed to win some money back.

So I texted back. **-do you care?**

I got a quick response.

-Of course I care.

What an act she was putting on. She didn't know I knew about her infidelity, but still. Wanting to see me right after sharing our bed with another man. What kind of woman does that? Schedules a lover between lunch and dinner with her husband. Boy was I feeling bitter.

-Peter, where are you? She spelled it out, I supposed that meant she was getting serious.

-I'm playing blackjack.

-what about our date?

Our date, that was funny. **-Do you really care?**

-Yes Peter I care!!

Double exclamation points. That must mean she really did care. Hah. I texted the picture I took of her and Scott in mid-thrust.

I didn't get a response back right away. I could only guess what thoughts were running through her mind. Like 'Oh my God how did he get this picture?' or 'I hope the guy next to me at the restaurant can't see this.' or maybe even 'Damn, Scott has a nice ass.'

Oh, I was really working myself up. I had to remain calm and in control even if my heart was racing. Actually looking at the picture I had to admit. Scott did look pretty sexy from behind. I giggled a little and that helped.

-Peter, we have to talk. She finally texted back.

I didn't reply. I didn't know what to say. I wasn't ready yet. I would either cave into whatever crazy story she came up with or I would get crazy

myself and say things to hurt her. Hurt her like she hurt me. I didn't want to do that.

-Peter, meet me at the Heart bar. She still thought I was at Planet Hollywood. Silly girl.

-I'm not ready to talk yet, I texted.

-when will you be?

-Don't know, I'll get back to you. I wanted to add something about Scott helping her pass the time, but I didn't. I guess that was a good sign I was healing. I turned the phone off. I didn't want to deal with anymore distractions.

I went back to the table and continued playing. While I played I kept going over everything that happened today. I couldn't wrap my head around the fact that she had sex with me at noon and then had sex with Scott about an hour and a half later. It didn't make sense to me.

Then it dawned on me that we didn't actually have intercourse. She gave me a blow job but she didn't let me inside her. I had put it off to not having enough time. I only had a brief window of opportunity before I had to get back to my meetings.

In hindsight, she didn't want to have sex with me because she wanted to keep herself clean for Scott, no sloppy seconds for him. I threw my two hole cards at the dealer.

"Sir, please don't throw the cards." These Vegas dealers are always polite.

I looked down at my stack of chips. I had about a hundred and fifty dollars left. I decided I had enough of this. I couldn't even concentrate on the cards. I think I had just thrown away a ten-jack.

"Color me out," I said as I slid my chips his way. The dealer took my stack and counted it out. He tossed me a black chip and two of my green

ones back.

"Good Luck," he said as I walked away. Good Luck? What the fuck does that even mean, coming from a dealer? In the long run, only the house wins.

I went to the casino lounge to self-medicate my depression away.

Not a lot was going on. One guy was at the bar playing video poker and nursing a free drink. Most of the tables were empty. At one a man and a woman, both white, seemed to be arguing about something. At another table a couple of women seemed to be getting along just fine. One looked Asian with shoulder length blond hair. She had her hands on the thigh of another woman, who had beautiful ebony skin, her curly brown hair cut close to her scalp.

Any other time I would get hard watching two lovely women getting it on, but not tonight.

I sat at the bar and ordered a Guinness.

"How much?" I asked the bartender when he brought my drink.

"It's six bucks," he said. "But it's free if you play."

I didn't feel like playing. I gave him one of my green chips to cover my first three drinks. I told him he could keep the rest.

"Whatever," he said and went back to cutting up limes.

I took a drink. I thought of Robin on her back taking in Scott's cock. I took another drink. I thought of Robin bobbing up and down on my dick until I came in her mouth. I took another drink. I thought of the tiger on Scott's back. A strong primal animal, taking what it wanted, leaving scraps for the lesser members of the pack. I downed the rest of my beer.

I waved my empty glass. The bartender started to draw me another.

Man, I was getting hard thinking of my wife having sex, whether it was with me or Scott. She looked so beautiful giving and receiving pleasure. I never realized that something could be so beautiful and sexy and wonderful, yet so painful at the same time. If there was just some way to get rid of the pain.

"Thanks," I said to the bartender as he placed my second beer down.

"Hey bartender," came a familiar female voice behind me. "Can I get a.." She didn't finish her request.

I turned to see who it was and why she had gone silent. It was the blond Asian girl. She looked even better up close. She wore a tight dark blue skirt that just covered her butt, and a pink blouse with more than enough buttons undone to show off her generous cleavage. I had to force myself to look up at her face. It took me a second to realize who it was.

"Doctor Cho," I said. "Are you following me?"

"Doctor Wilkenson, I was here first."

For some reason, my gaze started to slide down her face, drawn by her incredible décolletage. "Call me Peter," I said to her breasts.

She paused. She waited, saying nothing. The silence caught me by surprise and I looked back up into her eyes.

"Enjoy the view?" she said, with a smile.

"Yeah. I mean, no. I mean yeah. Wow, I didn't recognize you. That's a wig, right?"

"Duh, men are all alike."

"Why aren't you at the conference?"

"It's my free day today. I've got every hour crammed tomorrow."

I was about to tell her that tomorrow was my free day when I noticed her companion was getting up to leave.

"I think your lady friend doesn't like you talking to strangers." I pointed towards the other woman heading out of the lounge and towards the casino.

"Excuse me," she said. "Sylvia, wait," she called out as she ran towards the ebony beauty. She caught up with her near a row of slot machines. There was no way to tell what they were saying, but it was obviously not going to be an amicable parting. Besides me and one of the other guys at the bar, the rest of the patrons were ignoring the dispute.

I decided to get back to my drink. I had my own problems to worry about. Eventually, Dr. Cho came back and took a seat next to be.

"Cinnamon Appletini, please," she said to the bartender.

I wasn't sure why she came back to sit next to me. I tried not to give the impression I was looking for a drinking companion. I took a sip of beer.

"So why are *you* playing hooky today, Peter?"

"I'd rather not talk about it." I was hoping she'd go away, but I didn't want to be rude about it.

"Oh come on. I'm a near stranger. Let it go."

She just couldn't take a hint.

"You're right, Doctor Cho. You're a stranger and it's personal."

"Who better to tell your problems to than a stranger?"

I turned to face her. I really wanted her to leave. "Let me be clear. I don't mean to be rude, but I don't want to talk right now."

Doctor Cho looked me in the eye. She held the gaze, taking a measure of how serious I was.

"Fine," she said grabbing her drink. "And the name's Kelly by the way. I'll be over there." She went back to her table.

I watched Kelly walk away. I couldn't help but notice her lovely round ass sway back and forth. At least I could still appreciate a beautiful woman. It was good to know I wasn't totally dead inside. I wasn't the only one in the bar who liked Doctor Cho's ass. I saw a guy at the end watching. He looked at me and nodded his head in approval. I nodded back. A universal guy sign, acknowledging a fine woman. If only we weren't such dicks about it.

I took another sip of my beer. I wanted to find out what time it was. I checked my phone, but the screen was black. I forgot I had turned it off. After it came back on, I found out I had several voice mail messages and one text, all from Robin.

-Peter, I love you.

Right, she loved me. Fine fucking way to show it. A guy would never do what she did. He might cheat, he might lie, he might break her heart, but no guy would be mean enough to pick up a woman when he was on vacation with another. At least he wouldn't if he really loved the first one.

How could she be so naïve? She said she didn't want anything to come between us. I know I heard that. Was I mistaken? Was she mistaken? Did she overestimate her self-control? No, the text messages proved pre-meditation. She knew she was going to fuck Scott before and during her romp with me. But why plan an elaborate lunch for me? She must still have some feelings for me or she would have bailed out on lunch to spend more time with her lover.

I was really confused, in over my head, and lost. I wanted to ask Robin what the fuck she was thinking, but I wasn't ready for that yet. I needed to find out how women think. I needed to understand what makes women cheat on their husbands. I needed another perspective.

I could call my sister, Suzie, in Scottsdale. She and I were pretty close. I was ten years older than her. My dad left us when she was only four. My mother worked two jobs to support the family. I pretty much raised her. If

anyone could help, it would be Suzie. I tried calling her, but only got her voice mail. I left a brief message telling her to call me as soon as she could.

I thought about all of the women I knew at my clinic. I considered a few of them friends, but none I would pour out my heart to.

Then I looked back over at Doctor Cho. She was staring at me over her appletini. She knew I had an issue to deal with and she wanted to find out what it was. I couldn't blame her. In fact I wanted know what her story was, too. A married woman, alone in a bar hitting on other women. Sounded a lot like my wife, but at least Kelly didn't rub her husband's nose in it.

I decided I'd take a chance with the doctor. I asked the bartender if he could pour me another beer and make another Cinnamon Appletini. I tossed him my last green chip. "Keep it."

I took the drinks. Kelly's eyes lit up when she saw me head her way. As I approached I noticed her shit-eating grin.

"Thanks for the drink, mister," she said, batting her eyes. "You come here often?"

"Yeah, this is my favorite spot to pick up married women."

"I knew you'd come over."

"Let's play a game," I said.

"I love games. What do I get if I win?"

"Not that kinda game."

A wistful sigh escaped Kelly's delicate lips.

"It's simple: I ask you a question, you answer it truthfully. Then you ask me one. We trade information and both go away satisfied."

"I'll play, but I want to go first."

"Shoot."

"I see your wedding ring. Does your wife know you're alone in Vegas talking to strange women in bars?"

"You seem to be asking for a lot of information, not sure that's kosher. I am married obviously. My wife knows I'm in Vegas, she has no problem with me going out, and since she probably thinks I'm alone, that means she doesn't think I'm talking to strange women."

"That was a convoluted answer. A simple no would have been fine."

"Ok, my turn," I said. "Why isn't your husband here?"

"Oh, he is," Kelly said. She pointed to the man who had been watching her earlier. "Wave to Thomas." Thomas had light skin and caucasian features. His curly hair was cut short and he wore a full neatly trimmed beard. He was dressed for a night out, in a red and black striped button down and dark slacks.

"Why isn't he over here with you?" I asked. Maybe I was wrong about Kelly, maybe she did like to philander under her husband's nose.

"You're getting ahead of yourself. It's my turn. Is your wife here in Vegas, and, if so, where is she?"

"That's two questions, but I'll be nice and let it pass. Robin, that's my wife, is in Vegas. I can only say I think she's back at Planet Hollywood, but I'm not sure."

"What's the story behind that?"

"First you have to answer another question for me. Who was that woman you were talking to earlier and why was your husband watching you flirt with her?"

"Well now, there's a lot to unpack in that question." She paused to take a sip of her drink. "Promise this stays between you and me and this cinnamon apple vodka."

"Yeah, I promise. A toast, to telling secrets in Vegas." We touched glasses and took a drink.

"Okay. Simple answer. Thomas and I have what you would call an open marriage."

"Like in you cheat on each other."

"You should really keep your mouth shut and let me finish. If you mean do we sleep with other people, the answer is yes, but it's not cheating. We both love sex, a lot. We have lots of sex together. We also have sex with other people. Sometimes we like to watch each other have sex with other people. And sometimes we'll join in."

"That sounds like a lot of sex."

"Not really."

"And you never get jealous?"

"I guess our game is over. You're not following the rules."

"Ok, you finish your story and I'll tell you mine."

"Fine," she said. "Yes, I get jealous when I see my husband flirting with and fucking other women. It's like a little stab in the heart. But, there are two things to consider. One is I get lots of pleasure out of watching my husband enjoy himself. I like to see his eyes roll back when he's ready to cum. The pain of jealousy adds an edge to that pleasure, like a bitter spice that makes the meal. It's something I can't do when we're making love together and I'm lost in my only pleasure. The other and most important point is our love. I enjoy feeling lots of different cocks inside of me. But it's only sex. My husband is the only man I love."

And now, yesterday's encounter with Kelly and Jonathan at the pool was starting to make more sense to me. "And your husband's cool with this?"

"Thomas and I have been like this since college. We're both horn dogs."

"You also like sleeping with women, I see."

"Oh, yes. No man can lick a pussy as well as a woman. At least that's been my experience. I truly love my husband, but most women could lick laps around him on his best days. He has other ways to please me."

I was getting aroused listening to this woman tell me about her sexual exploits. I had never heard anyone talk about sex this way. I've never considered myself a prude, but I always thought sexual exclusivity was what bound a marriage. I had heard of open marriages, but never really understood them.

"So, if you and I went back to my room and had sex, your husband wouldn't consider that cheating?"

"No. Do you want to?"

That was a good question. I wasn't really considering it. It was just the first example that leapt to mind. I did find Kelly physically attractive. She was so different from my wife. For one thing her breasts were much bigger. She was a little shorter and just a little bit heavier. And obviously her eyes were different. Yes, I had to admit I wouldn't mind taking her to bed.

"You're thinking too hard," she said. "I wasn't really asking if you wanted to fuck."

"I know. I was just thinking about my situation and how similar it is to yours."

"Oh, your wife likes to fuck other men."

She hit it on the first shot. "It appears so," I said.

"And you don't like that?"

"I'd have to say no."

"Are you thinking about her fucking other men right now?"

"Well *now* I am, thanks."

"It doesn't seem to bother your dick." She pointed to my crotch. My erection was visible through my jeans.

"So, you don't like thinking about your wife enjoying sex with others."

"It's not the thinking. It's the knowing. I've seen it."

"So you'd rather not know?"

"No, I'd rather she didn't do it."

"Let's try this a different way," Kelly said. "You said you saw her have sex with another man, correct?"

"Yeah."

"Ok, step back and look again. Did you see how much she was enjoying it?"

"Yes."

"Do you like to see your wife enjoy herself?"

"Yes, and I'll tell you the truth, she looked sexy as hell. If I could just block Scott out of the picture."

"So her lover's name was Scott. Anyone you know?"

"Kinda, but not really. We only just met him on Monday. Long story."

"Oh, Peter, we have all night. I'm not going anywhere."

So I told Kelly Cho, a woman I had known for a shorter amount of time than Scott, all about the last two terrible days. I told her about winning at roulette, our celebratory dinner and how hot my wife was that first night.

"Yeah, he really turned her on. Don't take this personally, but I don't think she was thinking about you while you were pounding away that night."

"Thanks, you gonna let me finish?" I went on about their shopping spree, seeing the show and their late night kiss at the door. I told her about the lunch time blow job, the text messages, and catching them in the act. I even told her about the photo.

"Oh, you took a picture? Let me see it."

I showed her. I was baring my deepest pain to this woman; showing her a picture of my wife and her lover didn't seem that out of bounds.

"Wow, that's a nice shot. I could really masturbate to this."

"I think I missed my calling, should have gone into porno photography."

"This is good, see? You can laugh about it. All isn't lost."

"I could just be getting numb."

"Is she still with this man?"

"I don't know. She was supposed to meet me for dinner. I assumed it would be alone, but since I didn't show up -." I paused, to let my unspoken doubts settle in. I still couldn't believe I was spilling my deepest anxieties to this woman I hardly knew. "She's waiting for me to let her know when I'm ready to talk."

"She knows you're aware she's cheated on you."

"Yeah, I sent her the picture."

"Nice one. Ok, let's bottom line this. Do you still love her?"

"Yes," I said without hesitation.

"Does she still love you?"

I had to think hard before I said, "She says she does, I'll have to take her word for it."

"Can you forgive her for going behind your back?"

"I don't know."

"Well, if you want to save your marriage, you're going to have to."

"Since when did you become a marriage counselor?"

"Since you bought me this drink."

"I think I do," I said, "save my marriage, that is."

"If she feels the same way, there's a chance this might work out."

"What do you mean, a chance?"

"Peter, this is going to be hard on you. You are going to have to accept that your wife likes fucking other men. She's done it once. Things can never go back to the way they were. There are only a few options, and it will be up to the both of you to agree on which one it is."

"Go ahead."

"Option one, go back home. You forgive her and she promises never to cheat on you again."

"That sounds like going back to the way things were."

"Sounds like it, but isn't. She'll say she won't cheat, but she probably will, she'll just be more discreet. Even if she doesn't cheat, she'll resent you for denying her that pleasure. And even if she's happy and faithful, you'll never trust her like you used to. You know what she's capable of."

"What's the other option?"

"You let her indulge her sexual craving."

“Like an open marriage?”

"You don't have to call it that, but yeah. Set a few ground rules and move on. The fewer rules you have the better. I'd recommend just one, be honest and be accepting. Shut up, I know that's two. It's the way Thomas and I live, and we are very happy."

"This is all too much, too fast. I just want to go home and pretend this didn't happen."

"It did happen. You have to accept Robin is not the same woman you came here with."

I didn't want to admit it, but I knew Kelly was right. Our marriage was irrevocably changed. I had to accept that whether I liked it or not. I got up to leave.

“Thanks, Kelly. You gave me something to think about.”

Kelly reached into her clutch and pulled out an all black business card.

"What is this?"

"It's my personal card." She pulled out what looked like a flashlight, but with a dark bulb. It was an ultraviolet light. She pointed it at the card. The words Kelly Cho and a phone number appeared under its purplish glow.

"Very classy, I see you've kept your maiden name."

"No. My family name was Park."

I looked again at the man she said was her husband.

"Really? His last name is Cho?"

"He was adopted."

"Life is weird."

"You're just finding this out now? You've lead a sheltered life, Peter." She kissed my cheek. "You ever need anything, just call." She leaned over to whisper in my ear. "You sure you don't want to go back to my room and screw?"

"It's tempting," I laughed. "But I have a marriage to save, and that probably wouldn't help."

She shrugged, "You never know. Well, you have my number."

We said our goodbyes. Kelly went back to her husband. He greeted her by grabbing her ass and giving her a passionate kiss.

I texted my wife.

-I'm ready to talk now. Meet me at the Heart Bar.

Robin sits alone on the window sill in the hotel room, wearing nothing but one of Peter's T-shirts. The room is shrouded in darkness. The circus that is Vegas plays below.

The text comes in, briefly illuminating Robins face. She has been crying.

Peter is ready. Is she?

She pulls the front of the shirt up and buries her face in the fabric. She breathes in Peter's scent. The strong, musky odor of her husband invades her nostrils. She feels a pleasant stirring in her core.

She is searching for a reason, a motive for her infidelity, but she can't find one.

She loves her husband; she's getting wet just thinking about being with him again.

Scott looms in the back of her mind. She can't forget about him. She doesn't want to forget about him.

Why did she cheat? Why does anyone cheat?

There are a million different reasons, and no reason. We cheat because we are human.

Robin begins to dress and prepares to go down to meet her husband.

Chapter 7

I took my time heading back to the hotel. Before I could confront Robin, I had to come to terms with my own feelings. My conversation with Kelly really opened my eyes and made me realize I had lots of issues to work out.

The anger and depression were easy. Robin cheated on me. She had sex with another man behind my back. I thought I could trust my wife, but I was wrong. That hurt, but I'd have to get past the pain if I wanted to save our marriage.

While I was walking past the new Quad resort, I started thinking about how many changes the Vegas strip had seen over the years. One casino gets bought out by another, it gets demolished and a new one takes its place. Gone were the Sands, the Dunes, and the Aladdin. Life goes on.

I thought about starting my own life over, being single, only having to care about myself. Vegas is known for weddings, but divorces can be had just as easily. We didn't have kids or much of an estate. We could probably get a lawyer to draw up the papers for a few hundred dollars. Wouldn't that be funny, getting a divorce on our anniversary?

My eyes started to well up when I thought about coming home from work to an empty house. I didn't want to live alone. I didn't want to live with anyone else but Robin. I wanted to stay married.

I was about halfway back when I decided I still loved Robin and still wanted her to be my wife. I just needed a way to make that happen. Kelly was right though, I had to accept that Robin was a changed woman. We could never go back to the way things were.

I wanted to trust her, but I don't believe I ever could again, unless I was able to accept her new sensuality. I played back the live action porno of my wife and her lover that would be forever etched into my memory. And God help me if I didn't get an erection. The vision of my wife in the throes of ecstasy aroused me. Was that wrong? It wasn't in the Cho family. Robin was a very sexy woman; maybe I could learn to enjoy just watching her have sex, without being involved.

Maybe an open marriage would work. Robin and I could stay married, and she could explore her desires. Hell, there might even be some other benefits I hadn't thought of just yet.

I was rushing up the steps to the main casino entrance when I made my decision. I loved Robin, wanted to be her husband, and would work to accept the woman she had become. Now it would be up to her to decide if she wanted to stay married to me.

I laughed at the thought that all my painful soul searching would be for naught if Robin asked for a divorce. Then I almost started to cry.

The Heart Bar is in the center of the Planet Hollywood casino floor, hence the name. It's an island in the midst of a sea of slot machines and gaming tables. You can sit at the bar and play video poker, or lounge around on a couch and watch a ball game on one of the big screen TV's.

I made my way straight to the bar. I didn't even bother to look at any of the beautiful young women who dealt cards and danced on the tables in the Passion Pit. My mind was focused on one thing, saving my marriage.

I saw her before she saw me. Robin was sitting alone on one of the high-backed couches looking out over the casino, nursing a drink. She wore a simple short sleeve red and white striped dress that came down to her knees. I didn't think she was wearing any makeup, but to me she was the most beautiful woman in the bar.

I wasn't the only one who thought that. I watched as another man approached her with two drinks in his hand. He couldn't have been more than 23. His skin was a golden hue, obviously from spending lots of time in the sun, or under a tanning light. He was a little taller than me, with an athlete's body. He wore khaki pants and a black and tan Hawaiian print

shirt, with the top four buttons undone. I wouldn't have been surprised if he was a tennis player, or maybe a surfer.

He started talking to Robin, but I couldn't hear what he was saying. It looked like he was offering her one of the drinks.

For a moment I thought about him and Robin, upstairs in bed. Him on his back, her riding him like a cowgirl, head thrown back, pinching her own nipples. I felt a stirring in my loins, but surprisingly only a little jealousy.

Robin must not have been picturing the same thing, because she shook her head and he walked away. He must not have been too upset because he made a bee line towards a tall white blond woman who had just sat down at the bar. At that moment he stopped being my concern.

"Can I buy a pretty lady a drink?" I asked in my sleaziest voice.

Robin didn't look up before saying, "No, I'm waiting for someone."

"I hope it's me."

"Peter!" she nearly screamed. She jumped up and threw her arms around me. I could feel the condensation on her drink glass leaving a wet spot on the back of my shirt. I hugged her back. I gave her a tight hug and didn't think I ever wanted to let go.

I could hear her sniffing in my ear. She was crying. "I'm so sorry," she whispered.

We finally broke our embrace and sat down. We didn't say anything. It seemed like days since we had last seen each other, but in reality it had only been seven hours. Well, I had seen her more recently, but I wasn't counting that.

I finally broke the silence. "Really, can I get you another drink?" Yes, I started with a weak pick-up line.

"No," she said. "I'm just having club soda."

"Well, I'm thirsty." I got up to get a drink. I brought back two club sodas. Robin was alone when I returned.

Again there was silence between us. Neither wanting to start. Ever the physician, I saw our relationship as being deeply wounded and starting to scab over. But there was an infection present, and we were going to have to re-open the wound and clean it out before we could heal.

Since I was the doctor, I guess it was up to me to start.

"You said we needed to talk," I said. "Here, I am. I'm ready to listen."

Robin looked me in the eye. "Peter, you have to believe me, I didn't intend to hurt you."

"Robin, this is only going to work if we are completely honest with each other. No bull shit."

"I'm not lying."

"Robin, I saw the text messages. You planned to give me head one hour, and fuck Scott the next."

"You saw the texts?"

"Yes, that's what made me come back to the room to see what you were doing." I told her about getting the key to the other room.

"You should have been a spy."

"From this point on, no lying. Any more lies and I think that means we don't want to be married anymore."

"Peter, I'm not lying. I didn't mean to hurt you. I thought I had everything under control."

"You were planning on keeping the affair a secret?"

"Yes."

"You weren't very good at it. I saw you kissing last night. I also saw the hickey on your breast."

"I don't know what to say Peter. Do you want a divorce?"

"Hell. No. I love you, that's why I'm so hurt."

"So you want to forgive me and move on?"

"No."

"What?"

"I can forgive you, but I'm going to need to understand why." I told Robin about my conversation with Kelly Cho. About how she pointed out I would never be able to just trust her to stay faithful to me, and how she would resent me if she tried.

"She's right, you know."

"So, do you want to stay with me? Do you think you could be happy being my wife?"

"Oh, Peter. Yes, yes, yes. I do love you and I couldn't be happier."

"Okay, that's a good start. Now tell me why the fuck you hooked up with Scott."

"Peter, I didn't mean for things to work out the way they did. It's just that one thing lead to another." Robin then explained to me how she and Scott ended up in our bed.

She admitted from the beginning she found him sexy, and the more they talked the more interesting he became. She also confirmed what Kelly had said. She was thinking about Scott while I was fucking her that first night. The admission stung a little, but it was also pretty hot. I was finally seeing my wife as a sexual being with her own desires.

She had only intended on sending Scott the pictures Tuesday morning, but then he invited her to lunch. She thought I was tied up at the conference so she agreed. During lunch they talked about their careers. Scott told her how he was looking forward to finishing the start-ups in KC so he could move on to Sedona. Robin told him about her part time job selling art at a little boutique in Tempe.

"We talked about other things to do in Vegas besides gamble," Robin said. "I told him I'd like to do some shopping and see at least one show. He told me about Zumanity and it sounded really interesting. Plus, I'll be honest, I got wet sitting there listening to him explain some of the acts. I'm sorry if that sounds crass, but you said you wanted honesty."

"I know, honey," I said. "Scott has a charming personality. It's hard for me to compete with that."

"Peter, you don't have to compete. I'm your wife. I've chosen you."

She said she had planned on just buying a pair of tickets for us, but Scott said he'd like to go, too, and she found it impossible to say no to him.

After lunch they went shopping. They went dress shopping first. She tried on about three or four different ones. Yes, one was six thousand dollars and Scott offered to buy it for her. Even she thought that was too much, so she settled on the less expensive one that was just as gorgeous.

"We passed a bathing suit store, and that's how we got the idea to go swimming. He wanted to buy me that suit, too, but I didn't let him." They were going to go to the pool at the Aria. "I asked Scott if you'd be able to get in. He told me he could only have one guest. I wasn't going to leave you out, so we decided he would be my guest here instead."

"Whose idea was the haircut?"

"Mine. We stopped at a salon so he could get a trim. I was browsing through the magazines when I saw a model who looked kind of like me, but had this hair style. I thought it looked good."

"What about shaving your pussy?"

Robin stopped talking. She was trying to decide what to say next. "You really want to know?"

"Yes."

"It was Scott's idea. He joked about it while I was getting my hair cut."

"How did he know you weren't already shaved down there?"

"He might have got a glimpse of something while I was trying on bathing suits."

"So you shaved yourself for him?"

"No. To be honest, I shaved for all three of us."

"You knew he was going to fuck you this morning, while you did it."

She gave a hesitant yes. "But you're getting ahead of me. The more time I spent with Scott, the more I liked him. I had fun with him. He made me laugh. He had interesting stories to tell. I love you, Peter, and I love spending time with you, but Scott is different."

"You do know that when you say 'but' you're dismissing everything you said before it."

"Peter. No. I love you. Period. You're my husband and my soul mate. I would be lost without you. Being with Scott was like getting to know a new friend."

"So what happened after the show?"

"I told you. We went to a pub, we went dancing and gambled a little."

"Be honest Robin. You left something out."

"Yes. He invited me up to his room at the Aria. I'm being totally honest when I tell you I had no intention of doing what I did."

"What did you do?"

"I'll get to that. First we talked, he opened a bottle of wine and we had a glass. We sat on the couch at a respectable distance at first. But every few moments we would be drawn a little closer together. I found him so sexy, almost irresistible. I really wanted to kiss him. I had since our lunch date. I almost kissed him in front of you at the show. Remember when I tripped?"

"Yes. I'll admit I found it kinda hot."

"What!?"

"I'll explain later, continue."

"Well, we finally did kiss. And I'll admit I felt giddy. Like a teenager locking lips with her boyfriend under the bleachers. It felt so wrong, but I really wanted it. I thought after this week it would be nothing but a memory to masturbate to."

She said that was when her hand brushed his cock. It was swollen in his pants and she said it felt huge. She didn't compare his penis to mine, thankfully. I didn't think I was ready for that. Once physical contact was made with his cock, things moved swiftly. She didn't go into extreme details, but she did hit the high points. She admitted there was heavy petting. She took off her bra and he sucked on her breasts. I knew that much. He also penetrated her with his fingers. She rubbed his cock through his pants.

"It was getting late and I knew we should stop. That's when he told me he had condoms and asked if I wanted to make love."

I hoped Robin couldn't see that I was getting aroused while she explained her indiscretions. "Did you?"

"I won't lie. I wanted to. I just wasn't ready. I was still working out all these new feelings. I really enjoy when we have sex. You know my body and what I like. Scott was different. He was someone new, and I wanted to try something new."

"So you left him with blue balls?"

"You really want to know?"

"For the love of God, if I didn't want to know I wouldn't be asking."

"We didn't screw, but I did give him head. I didn't want to leave him disappointed, and I also really wanted to see what his cock looked like. What it felt like."

For some reason I felt like asking the question every guy wants to know. I felt ready to know. "Is he bigger than I am?"

She mulled over the answer in her head before she spoke. "I really couldn't tell you. Sorry to break it to you, but when it comes to what you're packing in your pants, you both are average sized men."

"You've had bigger?"

"Maybe," she replied with a smile.

She said Scott let her take a shower before he walked her back over to our hotel. That was when she decided she was going to fuck him. She just didn't tell him yet. She also told me that's when she thought up her lunch surprise for me. She felt guilty for what she was planning.

"So giving me head was some kind of consolation prize?"

"Kinda, but not really."

"So did you let Scott cum in your mouth like you let me?"

"You really want the graphic details?"

"Truthfully, yes. It honestly arouses me."

"Really?"

"I told you I'll explain later. We really need to get this out in the open."

"Ok. I wasn't planning on letting him cum in my mouth. You know I've never let any man do that. Unfortunately, I was enjoying myself too much. I was only using my mouth and one hand to suck him off. The other was between my legs. I didn't notice the signs of his impending release and he didn't warn me."

"What a gentleman."

"I didn't tell him he needed to. Anyway, he surprised me by filling my mouth and I swallowed. It turns out it's not so bad."

After that, there wasn't much to tell. Scott waited until he saw me exit the elevator and head to the conference before going up to the room. He had brought the five condoms but they only needed one. I asked her for the details of what I didn't see. She said the foreplay lasted half an hour. They kissed and fondled each other. She spent quality time exploring his body. She admitted to me she climaxed three times. Twice while he ate her out, and once when he was inside her. She also gave him head in the shower.

"Peter, I'm being honest when I say, I thought that would be the end. I'd get it out of my system and we could move on. I'm still willing to give that a try"

"You're telling me we could go back to the way things were?"

"Sure. Our marriage is important. You're important."

"There is another option."

I explained the concept of an open marriage. How it worked for Kelly and Thomas Cho. She could have sex with other men under one condition. Total honesty. Never lie about where she was, who she was with and what she was doing.

"And you'd let me do that?"

"Actually there's one other condition."

"What?"

"That I get to watch sometimes."

My wife looked stunned. Her eyes became huge saucers. Her jaw loosened and her mouth hung open. "Really!?"

"It was so hot watching you fuck. You're so beautiful and sexy. I love seeing you happy and fulfilled. I just want to be a part of it."

"I was being fulfilled that's for sure." We both laughed. That was a good sign. "And you wouldn't get jealous?"

"Of course I'd be jealous. It would hurt, but actually the pain feels kinda good. I couldn't admit it at first, but once I made up my mind to let you fuck other men, I allowed myself to enjoy it. But we always have to be upfront and honest."

"Peter, I hate to break your bubble, but I don't want an open marriage. I don't really want to fuck other men, and just the thought of you putting your dick in another woman is driving me crazy."

"So you wouldn't resent me for making you give up strange cock?"

"Promise. As long as you don't think I'm out sucking some dude off in an alley, every time I don't answer the phone right away."

"It's a deal. So what about Scott?"

"He's expecting me to call him tomorrow."

"Does he know I know?"

"No."

"Did you want to see him?"

"Honestly, yes."

"Okay, we have to stop saying that. If we say honestly before we answer a question, that means we might not be being honest other times. Open marriage or no, the truth is important."

"Okay, no more saying honest."

"Do you want to fuck Scott again?"

"Damn you, Peter. Why did you have to ask that?"

"Because I want to know."

She stared at me, anger and apprehension in her eyes. She was mad I asked the question and afraid about the answer.

"Honest... damn it."

"A simple yes or no will do."

"Okay, yes, Peter. Yes, I want to fuck Scott again. You and Scott are the only two men I want to fuck."

That was a surprising answer, but it slipped by me at the time.

"What if I say I wouldn't mind if you did?"

"Well, since we have the understanding of total honesty, I'd say okay. I'd also ask you if you'd hate me for it?"

"No. I want you to be happy, Robin. Anything that makes you happy, makes me happy. I've come to accept that."

"So, you'll let me have another go at Scott?"

"Consider it an anniversary gift."

"You're funny."

"There is one other thing."

"Oh, I knew there was a catch. What is it?"

"You have to let me watch."

Total honesty, no lies.

What about half-truths? Do two half-truths equal a whole one?

Robin knows she loves Peter, her husband, but she also knows, deep down, her crush on Scott is growing into something more.

Maybe one more fuck, one more orgasm (maybe two or three), and she will be free of the desire.

She has already broken the deal. She has lied to herself.

Chapter 8

"I think I'll take that drink now," my wife said. I went to the bar and brought back two gin and sodas.

"So, you want to watch? What brought that up?"

"Seeing you fuck him the first time."

"But weren't you mad?"

"Yeah, I was furious, but also incredibly turned on. Part of my brain ignored the fact it was you on the bed and just enjoyed itself."

"So I'm a porn star now?"

"I wouldn't go that far. It's just that two beautiful people giving each other pleasure is art. You and Scott are both nice to look at."

"You admire Scott's body?"

"Sorta. Not like I wanna suck his dick or anything. He just seems really fit."

Robin laughed. "Last week I'd have called you crazy for suggesting my cheating got you hard."

"Last week I hadn't seen you and Scott go at it. So do we have a deal?"

"I'm not sure? What are we agreeing to?"

"You don't want an open marriage, but you wouldn't mind one last go round with your boyfriend."

"He's not my boyfriend," Robin said with a little too much indignity. "But yeah, I'm getting a little wet thinking about it."

"Ok. I'll agree to suspending our vows for a day, as long as I get to watch."

"You want to hide in the closet or something?"

"No. I want to be in the room. I want to be able to see and hear everything. No restrictions."

"What if Scott doesn't agree?"

"If it means he gets to have sex with you again, I think he'll agree."

"Ok. Let's do it," Robin said. "Now take me back to the room and make love to me. I'm about to leak all over this couch."

That night we made love. It was frantic at first. We tore each other's clothes off as soon as our room door closed behind us. It was like make up sex. Our marriage had almost been destroyed, but we somehow saved it.

I was reminded of the night I proposed. Robin had just got back from a trip east to see her family. I pretended to forget it was her birthday. She got really upset, telling me how she could have stayed in Jersey and celebrated with her folks. That's when I pulled out the ring. At first she got mad.

"Peter, you shit. How dare you pull a stunt like that?"

"I wanted to surprise you."

"Well you did."

Then she started to cry. I held her tight. Then she looked up into my eyes and grasped my cock.

"I've really missed this," she said.

I grabbed her boobs in retaliation. "I missed you, too," I replied. "I didn't even play with myself the whole week you were gone."

"You're lying, but I don't care."

I started frantically opening up her blouse, breaking at least two buttons. She took off my belt and slapped my ass with it. We made love all night. I came three times, which is still a 24-hour record for me. I think Robin came at least as many times. I never asked, maybe I should have.

Now I was back in the present. I was excited about watching her tomorrow, but I still would have preferred we never arrived at this point. Maybe if I had been more attentive to Robin's needs she wouldn't have strayed.

As soon as we were free of our clothes, I threw her down on the bed. She spread her legs and beckoned me. I slid in and began to thrust. I started slow, but then increased my speed until I could hear my balls slapping against her butt.

I came first. All the pent up pain and frustration released in a grand explosion of semen. Robin cried out soon after. I think it was feeling my cum flood her vagina that set her off.

We took a short break to catch our breath. She lay against my chest while I ran my fingers up and down her arms.

"I am so in love with you, Peter." She had been teasing her fingers through my light chest hair, but now she worked her way down and started stroking my cock back to life. "I'm so lucky to have a man who cares so much and who's not afraid to let me explore."

"I don't own you, Robin. And I don't want to, I love you."

She lowered her head and took me into her mouth. This was the first time she ever gave me head right after I had been inside her. She always made me clean myself first. I don't think she liked tasting herself.

She continued sucking me until I was rock hard again. She threw a leg over my body and impaled herself on my cock and began to pump her hips. Robin's breasts aren't huge, but I still I loved watching them bounce up and down as she road me. It didn't take long for her to climax. The walls of her pussy clenched around my cock, igniting my second orgasm of the night.

We went to sleep shortly after, still caked in our own sweat and cum. It felt dirty, but oh so good.

We woke up around nine. We wished each other a happy anniversary, and then made love. This time it was slow and gentle.

After we got cleaned up, I went down to the conference. I begged the coordinators to pack up as many of the handouts and free samples that they could and ship them to my office in Phoenix. I had to salvage as much of this trip as possible.

Passing by one of the meeting rooms, I saw Dr. Cho, without her wig and sexy skirt. We made eye contact and I waved. She winked at me before putting her head back down into her notes.

While I was in the middle of damage control, I got a text from Robin.

-Called Scott, He'll be here at noon.

The plan was for Robin to tell Scott I had a mandatory lecture come up and she wanted to spend a little more time with him. She didn't want to mislead him by offering sex over the phone, but I'm sure he assumed that was on the table.

So that's how I ended up alone in the room next door to where my wife was propositioning another man on our wedding anniversary.

The insecure part of me was hoping Scott would be turned off by the idea. Maybe he wasn't too comfortable getting naked in front of a man. That would leave him vulnerable, unable to defend himself if I changed my mind. Robin agreed that if he wasn't willing to let me watch, then she wouldn't sleep with him again.

The horny side of me was excited about entering a new phase in our relationship. Seeing a side of Robin I had never been privy to before. Having her take part in an act of totally selfish sexual satisfaction.

My wife had relocked the partition door from the other side. I could hear them talking, but I couldn't make out what they were saying. What if Scott said no, but still wanted to have sex? What if Robin thought that was a good idea, as well? I wasn't sure she bought the whole watching game. I guess this would be the first test of our new honesty policy.

After a while, I couldn't hear them anymore. If Scott was game, Robin would open the door and let me in. If not, she would knock on the door twice. In that case, I was to head downstairs to the casino where she would meet me after saying goodbye to Scott. We had talked and decided a goodbye kiss was fine, maybe even some light over the clothes groping.

The silence coming from the next room was deafening. Did they start saying goodbye without Robin giving the signal?

I heard a single knock on the door. My bubble of excitement burst, but the disappointment was short lived when I heard the lock disengage and the door open just a crack.

I reached for the handle and stopped. I had been hit by a gut punch of emotion. The pain of knowing my wife really wanted to fuck another man washed over me. To my surprise, I realized I had become the most sexually aroused I'd ever been in my life. My skin tingled. My cock was so hard I didn't dare touch it, afraid I would make a mess.

It was now that I saw how much pleasure I got out of the pain of jealousy. I had just needed to survive the initial jolt. I entered the room in a hurry, in case they were thinking of getting started without me.

All the soul searching and agonizing of the past day did nothing to prepare me for what I saw when entered. My wife in the arms of another man, lips locked in a deep passionate kiss. Scott held her face in his hands while he explored her mouth with his tongue. I could just make out a few moans of pleasure escape their lips.

I was also stunned by what Robin was wearing. She had on a sheer white blouse through which you could clearly see her red bra underneath. I could also see a pair of matching lacy panties peeking out from the edges of her white shorts that barely covered her ass.

This was an outfit I had never seen before. She must have bought it earlier. Maybe when she was out with Scott. Had he picked it out? The thought of my wife shopping for provocative clothing with another man sent shivers of jealousy up my spine.

Despite my uneasiness, I found the sight highly erotic.

"Don't let me interrupt," I said in an attempt to break the ice. They didn't.

Robin began unbuttoning Scott's blue dress shirt. Her fingers moved slowly but steadily.

Scott looked up and acknowledged my presence. "Thank you," he said.

"For what?"

"For letting this happen. Not many men would."

"Not many men love their wives like mine does," Robin said as she worked her hands beneath the shirt to caress his chest.

Hearing my wife say that felt good despite watching her groping another man.

She proceeded to pull his shirt off, revealing Scott's smooth hairless pecs and abs. He obviously took advantage of owning a string of gyms. My wife's lover's muscles were not huge, but well-defined.

Robin traced her fingers delicately along the silhouette of a Chinese dragon that was tattooed on his left breast. The image encircled his nipple, which my wife took the opportunity to playfully nip at.

"I like your ink," I said.

Scott was only able to mumble a 'thanks.' His eyes were closed as he focused on what Robin was doing with her hands and mouth. He paused only long enough to add, "You'll excuse me if I'm not too talkative, your wife is very distracting."

At that moment, she was reaching her hands down his black jeans and pulling on his cock.

"Oh god, that feels so good Robin," Scott said. "I'm going to undress you now."

Robin nodded and pulled her hand out of his pants. Scott took her by the shoulders and turned her around to face me. My wife looked me in the eyes for the first time since I entered the room. I could see a passionate fire burning within her. A flame that threatened to engulf all in a destructive pyre. Robin, of course felt totally in control. She mouthed the words, "I love you."

Her eyes never left mine as Scott opened her top and slid it off her shoulders. It fell to a heap on the floor at her feet. She finally closed her eyes when he started kissing her neck. She flinched when he started softly nibbling on her ears.

She leaned her head back against Scott's powerful shoulders, lost in the pleasure of the moment, her erect nipples pressing against the red fabric that

encased her breasts. Scott unhooked the bra's front clasps, freeing them. He slipped the straps off her shoulders and let the bra drop to the floor, where it joined her blouse.

A soft moan escaped Robin's lips as Scott began massaging her bare bosom.

I was mesmerized by the scene playing out before me. For a moment it wasn't Robin being manipulated by another man, it was some other attractive brunette, with short spiked hair and perky breasts. My hands instinctively moved to my crotch and I started rubbing my cock through my pants.

Scott whispered something in my wife's ear. He began sliding his right hand slowly down her stomach. Robin unbuttoned her shorts to give his fingers easier access to her pussy. Her lover's hands disappeared into my wife's undies. Her eyes shot open and she took a quick breath. His fingers must have penetrated her.

My wife closed her eyes again and leaned back hard, enjoying the sensation as Scott worked his fingers through her wet folds. I could almost hear the moist motions.

"Oh..." my wife moaned. Scott kept kneading her left breast with one hand while the other worked its magic on her mound. Robin's moaning increased in intensity and volume.

I was enjoying the sight, but I had to stop rubbing myself or I'd make a mess, and I didn't want to do that just yet.

Without warning, my wife cried out Scott's name. She started shaking as the first orgasm of the afternoon spread through her body. Scott held her tightly in his arms until her climax ended.

"Fuck, that was awesome," she sighed. I silently agreed. "Oh my god, Scott, that was wonderful." She turned her head toward his and gave him a kiss. She turned back to me. "I hope you enjoyed that, Peter."

I could only nod my head.

Robin pointed to my crotch. "You're leaking," she said. I looked down, a bit of pre-cum had seeped through my pants. "I guess you really did enjoy it."

My wife turned to Scott and told him it was time to move to the bedroom. The lovers went into the next room hand in hand. I followed as far as the threshold. I stayed in the doorway to watch.

Robin sat on the edge of the bed helping Scott remove her shorts and panties. She was now completely naked, save for her wedding ring. Scott for his part was topless, but still wearing his jeans.

Robin lay back on the bed. Scott knelt between her outstretched knees and began kissing her inner thighs. I knew she liked when I did the same, and I was almost able to place myself in the scene imagining I was giving her the pleasure. Then she said, "Oh Scott, that's good," and I snapped out of it. He started making his way closer to her sex. "That's feeling even better," she said.

"Oh.. yeah there it is." Scott's mouth was now squarely on her pussy.

I looked up at Robin's face. She was looking back at me, as if to measure my response to her words. A look of pleasure mixed with concern shown through her eyes. I think she was worried about how I was feeling.

I wanted to reassure her. Let her know I was just fine. I smiled and mouthed, 'I love you.'

"I love you too, Peter," she said out loud.

"Calling out your husband's name while your lover eats you out," I said. "That has to be a breach of protocol."

Robin laughed. I thought I also heard a chuckle from Scott, his head still buried between her legs, his tongue working in and out of her folds.

"Here's another," she said. "Come here and give me a kiss."

I was shocked. My cock flinched and I almost came.

I entered the room and bent over to give my wife a kiss. Suddenly she started gasping in ecstasy. "Peter," she said, trying to talk between breathes. "Touch my tits." I did as I was told. I reached down and took hold of her breasts. I kneaded them a little and pinched her nipples between my fingers.

"Harder!" she commanded. I roughly groped her breasts and pinched hard.

"Ouch!"

"Sorry," I said, stopping.

"No! Don't you dare stop!"

I resumed my rough handling of my wife's breasts. A treatment she had never requested before.

"Oh.. Peter... Oh... Scott..." Robin was losing herself in the moment. "Oh my god, this is so wonderful."

I looked down and saw Scott was working a couple of his fingers in and out of Robin's vagina while rapidly lapping at her clit with his tongue. I continued massaging her breasts. It wasn't long before she was cumming again, her second orgasm of the day.

Both Scott and I backed away a little to watch. After she came down from her high, she looked at me. "Peter," she said, "get me a condom." The request was chilling and exciting at the same time. I was taking part in my own cuckolding.

"Where are they," I asked?

"In the nightstand." The answer came from Scott. Another stab in the heart as I remembered yesterday's tryst. I opened the drawer and saw a strip of four Trojans. I tore one off and tossed it to my wife. I went back to the doorway to watch as she instructed her lover to take his pants off.

Robin now sat on the edge of the bed. Scott stood in front of her, his crotch in her face. The only thing that stood between her lips and his engorged cock was the thin black fabric of his boxer briefs. She hooked her fingers into the waistband and pulled them down. His cock sprang out, almost slapping her in the face. She giggled and licked up the shaft.

"Tasty," she said. She lapped up a bead of pre-cum that was forming on his tip.

I watched as she rolled the condom on.

Even though I had already seen them fucking, I still couldn't believe what I was witnessing, and how hard it was making me.

Robin laid back, her knees in the air, her feet flat on the bed. Scott leaned into her and my wife eagerly guided his cock to its destination. He slid in with ease and began thrusting, slowly at first. I noticed the tiger on his back again, but unlike yesterday when it seemed fierce, today it just looked erotic as hell.

"Oh, that's nice," my wife said.

"You feel so good, Robin," Scott replied, picking up his pace.

Robin looked over at me. "I haven't forgotten you, love," she said. "Take off your clothes." The command surprised me. I wasn't planning on taking part, but I did what I was told. I quickly removed my clothes. I stood watching in only my briefs, my erection restrained against the fabric.

"Take those off, too."

I complied. My penis stood straight out. I felt a little embarrassed, but Scott wasn't paying any attention to me, and my wife was just licking her lips.

"Now, come here and kiss me."

I got on the bed and gave her a deep kiss, our tongues intertwined. I sensed a bit of salt.

"You can taste him," she said with a grin.

"Yes," I whispered in her ear. I kissed her again.

Robin gently pushed Scott away. "Peter, get behind me," she said.

I got on the bed. Robin nestled herself against me, her back against my chest, my legs on either side, my cock pressed between our bodies.

"Scott, you come here and get back inside me." My wife was directing her own porno shoot. Her lover repositioned his sheathed cock against her inflamed opening and resumed his thrusting. He leaned over and began kissing Robin as he fucked her. The intimacy was so intense and erotic.

I decided to ad-lib and reached between the lovers and grabbed Robin's breasts. "Oh, this is so good," she said. I roughly kneaded. Scott increased his pace, each thrust pushing my wife against me.

"Oh, god, I'm close," he said.

"I'm there," Robin said, as she let out a scream of passion. A scream the likes of which I had never heard come from her lips. She was experiencing sex like she never had before.

Scott's thrusting increased, rocking Robin's body back and forth. My cock was caught between us and the friction was driving me crazy. It was almost as if Scott was fucking the both of us.

Scott gave a final hard push and came with a loud guttural roar.

Then, unexpectedly, I came myself. I felt my cock pulsing, shooting my seed onto Robin's back.

"Shit," Robin said with a shock and she came again.

We collapsed in a heap on the bed, all three of us spent.

Scott got up first. "Mind if I take a shower?"

We laughed at the question and told him where the towels were. After sharing your wife with a man, it's only proper to offer him a shower.

Robin and I cuddled while Scott cleaned up. "We okay?" she asked.

"Ab-so-fucking-lutely," I said. "I wasn't expecting you to ask me to join in."

"I didn't plan it. It just felt right."

"I'm glad you did."

"I really do love you, Peter. You're so wonderful and I couldn't ask for a better husband."

"Happy Anniversary," I said.

"Happy Anniversary," she replied.

I took a shower next. When I came out I found Scott and Robin standing at the open door to our room. She had put on her panties and gauzy top. Her bare breasts were clearly visible to anyone who might pass by in the hall. They were saying goodbye.

"See ya later?" Scott asked, more hopeful than he looked.

"Maybe," Robin replied.

They exchanged a kiss and Scott left.

I was going to ask her about the 'See ya later' remark when Robin interrupted me.

"My turn," she said as she jumped into the shower.

She's not lying if she doesn't say anything.

The warm water feels so good. The guilt she felt before, washed away by Peter's blessing.

Sweet, sweet, Peter, her love and soul-mate. She thinks about her husband as she soaps up her small but sensitive breasts. Despite her recent fucking, she is still aroused.

She believes she will never leave Peter as long as he still wants her.

But Scott, rough and randy Scott, her lover and maybe more.

Both her hands glide down her taut stomach and come to rest on her mound. Slick fingers spread her pussy lips and explore the folds. She gently strokes her clit to the rhythm of some internal orchestra. She plays her body like a fine tuned instrument, her music is sexual pleasure.

It's Scott she thinks about when her orgasm hits its crescendo.

She loves Peter, with all her heart, but, she desires Scott.

The guilt returns.

Chapter 9

I threw on a pair of blue jeans and a pink polo shirt while Robin was in the bathroom cleaning up. I would have offered to help clean off the cum I left on her back, but she ran in the bathroom and closed the door before I could. She's usually not that private when showering, but when she closes the door, I know I need to just leave her alone. I'm sure she was taking the time to process what just happened, something I also had to do.

Did I really just watch another man have sex with my wife? Yes, I did. In fact I even helped.

From a young age men are taught the key to life is getting a good job, marrying a good woman and having kids. I had two of three. Our future plans did not include kids, neither of us really wanted them, and Robin had learned earlier in life that pregnancy could be dangerous for her. We were content with being a couple.

Now, if you ask most men, they'll deny seeing women as possessions. The majority of them are lying to you. Hell, just look at the standard American wedding ceremony. A father walking his daughter down the aisle, then giving her away to her future husband. How can you give away something that is not yours?

Men are allowed to be sexual beings, and there are certain accepted ways they are permitted to indulge their urges. Men are allowed to have mistresses, they can visit prostitutes.

Women are expected to make babies, male babies preferably.

In lots of cultures around the world women must dress modestly, if they aren't covered up completely. If a man is tempted, then it's the woman's fault. The difference between a being and an object.

Well, all I can say to that is bullshit. Women are sexual beings and they don't get their worth from how many male heirs they can produce.

My wife is my companion and best friend, but most of all she is a person just like me. It took me a while to wake up to that fact. It took her acting on her own sexual desires without me to realize it.

I love her. I enjoy making love with her. I also enjoyed sharing her coupling with Scott.

I felt like I almost lost her this week. I let my selfishness and anger control me. There are plenty of odd and scary and unusual experiences to be had in this life. I used to be afraid of the unknown, but not anymore.

When I was talking with Dr. Cho at the bar, she made a reference to a quote from the writer Anis Nin. She wrote, 'It is a sign of great inner insecurity to be hostile to the unfamiliar.' I didn't understand at first, but I think now I do.

I want to strive to not allow my own doubts to keep me from exploring the unknown. I want to experience more of this world. And I want to do it with Robin. In order to do that, I must accept she is also a person with her own inner desires. I can live with that.

Robin came out of the bathroom wearing something just a little more appropriate for going out in public, just a little. She had on a pair of brown cargo shorts that went halfway down her thigh. She wore the same transparent top but with an orange tank top underneath. From the way I could see her nipples it was obvious she had skipped the bra. On her feet she had a pair of white and black running shoes with white ankle socks.

"I think I want to get my nose pierced," she said with a smile.

I just looked at her. "I hope you're not trying to shock me," I said, "because it won't work."

We had dinner at a nearby Korean BBQ place. I really didn't know what to expect. How different could it be from Chinese?

The place was packed, mostly with groups of four to six Asian men in business suits. I had always believed any ethnic restaurant that was popular

with its native people had to be good. I don't know if that's always true, but it was this time.

My first surprise came when I took a sip of water the waitress brought us. It had a mild flavor to it; I later found out it was barley. When our food came it wasn't anything like Chinese, or American Chinese at least. The entree of grilled marinated beef was served with a variety of pickled vegetables. I recognized cabbage and cucumber. I think one was sweet radish. The rest were a mystery. I tried a little of everything. Most, I liked, or at least could stomach. A couple made me want to throw up.

After dinner we went across the Strip to the Monte Carlo Casino. We gambled there for a few hours. I lost about \$300 playing craps. Robin hit a small jackpot playing slots and won \$750.

Overall, we had a great evening out. It was a wonderful way to celebrate our love and our life together. We bought a bottle of cheap champagne at an ABC store and headed back to our room.

"A toast," I announced, "to three wonderful years with a wonderful woman." Tiny bubbles raced up the sides of the plastic cups we had to use since we didn't have any nice crystal flutes.

"And many more," Robin added.

We made love. It was mostly slow and tender and sweet. At one point it got a little silly when I poured bubbly on Robin's stomach and licked it out of her belly button.

After our lovemaking, we cuddled. I lay on my side with Robin's arms wrapped around me, her breasts pressed against my back. "I think this is a milestone for you," she said. I wasn't sure what she meant.

"Haven't you climaxed like five times in the last day?"

Then it hit me. "You remembered?" I asked with a laugh.

"Oh, hell yeah. I've been trying to help you break it ever since. I didn't know we needed outside help." She giggled.

"So has it been a record for you?"

"Honestly... damn! I said it again."

"Don't worry," I said. I couldn't help laughing. The champagne and the emotions of the moment just overwhelmed me. "Well, has it?"

"No, it's not a record."

"Really? So spill."

"I know you're looking for something tawdry, but it's not."

"I don't care. Let's just call it exploring our sexual past. So what's your record for most times cumming in a 24-hour period?"

"I can't tell you."

"Why."

"Cause I don't really know. I didn't count."

"What?"

"I don't remember the exact day. It was during the summer between my junior and senior year in high school. My parents were away and all my friends were off on family vacations. I was all alone. All I did that weekend was eat and sleep and play with myself. I really explored my limits. My pussy hurt for a month. I don't think I came again until I lost my virginity."

I knew that story.

Robin got up to go to the bathroom and clean the sticky mess off her stomach. I stayed in bed.

When she came back, she was wearing her bra and panties.

"What's up?" I asked. "Going somewhere?" It was 9:30.

Robin looked at me, her eyes searching, her mind looking for the words.

"Can I ask you something, Peter?"

She called me by my name. This couldn't be good. "Of course you can," I said.

"Promise you won't get mad."

"I promise."

"Swear?"

"I swear, now ask the goddamn question. You're worrying me."

"Would you mind if I spent the night with Scott?"

My heart skipped a beat and I began coughing uncontrollably. Robin quickly got me a glass of water and I took a sip.

"I wasn't expecting that," I said.

"Are you mad?"

"No." A half-truth, not mad but disappointed.

"It's probably the last time I'll get to see him," she said. She moved her hand in an attempt to play with a strand of hair that was no longer there.

"Whose idea was it?" I asked.

"Does it really matter," she asked.

Yes, I thought, it matters a lot. "Not really," I lied. I felt horrible not telling her the truth, but we were at a fragile point and I didn't want to add any more pressure. "But I'd like to know."

"Mine," she said, her eyes cast down.

"Robin, look at me." She raised her head. "Please don't ever be afraid to tell me or ask me anything." I tried to explain how I felt. How I wanted her to be free to be her own person.

"It won't always be easy, and I can't say I'll always like the things you do or say. But I swear I will always support you in whatever you do."

Robin wiped a tear from her eye. "What did I ever do to deserve you?" she said bending over to give me a kiss on the forehead.

"You did nothing. That's the point."

She jumped on the bed and we started making out like teenagers. Wet kisses, hands groping body parts. After a while she called a stop to it.

"Ok, that was fun but it's getting late and I have to be going."

Robin finished dressing, nothing fancy; just a simple yellow and white sundress. She wore a scarf to ward off the chill of the desert night.

When she was ready to go she asked me one last time, "Are you sure you're ok with this?"

My heart was broken, rent in two watching her get ready to go and meet her lover. But I saw she was happy and that made me happy.

Robin was being honest about her desires, and I knew if I didn't allow her to go, she would resent me. Not right away and not openly, but deep down she would feel like she missed something.

"Go," I said. "Have fun. And know I love you more than I can say. Just remember we have a 5pm flight tomorrow."

"Don't be a smartass, I'll be back with breakfast. I love you Peter Wilkenson, and I'm proud to call you my husband."

"Happy Anniversary, love," I said.

"Happy Anniversary."

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She stands at the door to his hotel room. She hesitates before knocking. She shivers and pulls her wrap tight around her shoulders, but it's not the temperature that brings the chill, apprehension, perhaps. Fear of the unknown. Fear of the future.

She feels horrible for leaving Peter alone in the room, but she thrills at spending one last night lost in desire.

She resolves to make it up to him, later, back in Phoenix. Her husband deserves so much better than this.

But still, she knocks.

Epilogue

I woke up to the sounds of a woman crying in the sitting room. There were no lights save for the neon glow coming from the open windows. The reds, and blues and greens danced and fluttered like faeries around the room.

“Robin,” I called out, “is that you?” I knew it was.

No answer came, only sobs.

I got up and entered the room. My wife was sitting on the sofa, her head buried in her hands.

“What's wrong, honey?” I asked. I wondered to myself if Scott had hurt her, somehow. The shadows cast by the exterior lights don't help me spot any bruises. Robin looked up at me. There were no marks on her face.

“I shouldn't have gone over there tonight,” she said, her voice barely audible.

I asked the question. “Did he hurt you?”

“Not really.”

Not really? What kind of an answer was that?

“He's put me in a difficult situation,” she said as if she could read my mind.

I really didn't understand what was going on. I sat down next to my wife and put my arm around her shoulder.

“Start at the beginning,” I said. “What did you guys do tonight?”

Robin told me they meant to have drinks at the pub, maybe gamble a bit. Instead they spent all their time up in his room making love.

Oh, what a phrase; making love. Not something you want to hear your spouse say they did with someone else. Fuck, screw, boink, all that can be

written off as just an act. Making love involves emotions. And that can get messy.

Still, I've come to accept some things, and so I accepted this. It was the revelations that followed that I wasn't prepared for.

“After we finished, he offered me my own spa.”

Deep down I had hoped to put Scott behind us. That wouldn't happen if Robin managed one of his businesses. He did say he only stopped by once or twice a year to check on things. I was sure he'd be making more trips than that to Phoenix.

I tried to take the situation in stride. It was hard, but this wasn't about me.

“So, where's the location? Downtown? Out by Fashion Square Mall in Scottsdale? How bout the Biltmore? Lots of idle money out there.” I could have gone on.

“No, Peter. Stop.” She took my face in her hands and looked me straight in the eyes. “It's his Sedona location.”

Fuck me, I thought. Sedona was more than a two-hour drive from where we lived. She couldn't commute that. I was afraid to ask the next question.

“What did you tell him?”

“I said I'd think about it and get back to him.” She didn't mention talking to me. And now this WAS about me.

Robin was taking this independent woman idea to the limit. The fact that she didn't seem to be interested in my input hurt. It hurt like a motherfucker.

“How are you leaning?” I asked.

“I've decided to take it. I just wanted to tell you first.”

Tell me first, how sweet of you, I thought, the words sticky with sarcasm.

“How will this work? He can't be paying you enough to support us in Sedona. Cost of living there is crazy.”

“No. I'll get an apartment. Maybe in Camp Verde or Flagstaff.”

The next question seemed obvious to me. “Do you want to separate?”

“NO, Peter. Oh, dear god, no. I love you... but.” She paused. “There's more to it.” The excitement had left her voice.

“What is it?” I asked. Nothing in the world could have prepared me for what she said next.

“Oh, I really shouldn't have gone over there tonight.” She started to cry again. “This is so hard to say Peter. It would be much easier if you weren't such a good, understanding man.”

I was really beginning to get nervous. This whole conversation was beginning to veer into the absurd.

“Peter, I love you so very much but...”

Remember what I said about the word 'but.'

“But, I think I'm also in love with Scott.”

To Be Continued

About the Author

I have been writing stories for about 15 years, mostly science fiction and fantasy. I came up with the idea for this story on a recent trip to Sin City. I was playing blackjack when I noticed a rather attractive couple playing roulette. Another man approached and started playing and they all seemed chummy. They might have all been friends, I took the situation in a different direction. Nothing else in this story even approaches reality. I do appreciate feedback and I can be reached at seangeist@outlook.com. You can also follow me on twitter @SeanGeist.